

AgFunder

**Global AgriFoodTech
Investment Report 2026**

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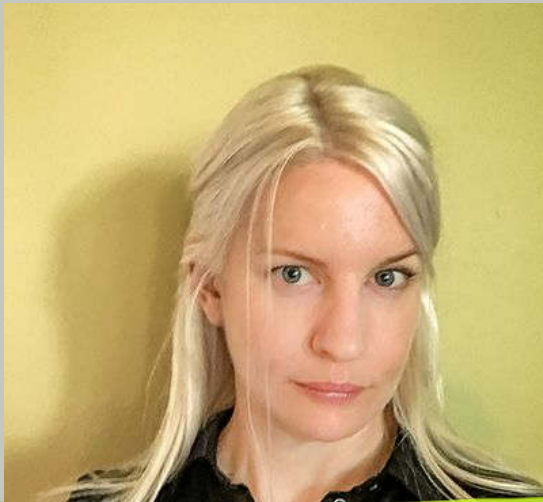
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ELAINE WATSON NEWS EDITOR

Letter from the authors

Global agrifoodtech investing in 2025

Global agrifoodtech funding hit \$16.2 billion in 2025, almost flat versus the prior year (-3%) but with a notable shift in where the money went.

Upstream startups—those building technology for farms, food production, and biological systems—drew \$9 billion, an increase of 7% year over year, even as deal count fell 12%.

Investors are writing fewer checks but directing more capital toward companies with tangible science, real unit economics, and clear paths to revenue. The era of growth-at-all-costs funding for food delivery and eGrocery platforms is fading. The largest deal of 2025, Wonder's \$600 million

Series D, was 80% smaller than the sector's peak round in 2021.

This year's report introduces our first dedicated deeptech analysis, spanning 10 pages and a decade of data. Deeptech's share of agrifood deals has climbed steadily from 22% to 32% over the past 10 years. Seed-stage deeptech rounds close at a 78% premium over non-deeptech equivalents, signaling genuine investor appetite for science-led companies. But no deeptech company broke \$200 million in a single round in 2025, a sign that growth investors remain cautious until the boom-era bets prove out commercially.

We also look at the growing role of debt financing, which hit

18.2% of total funding, its highest share in a decade. And climate-tech funding within agrifood recovered to \$3.9 billion, up 39% year-over-year.

Geographically, the US still leads at \$5.9 billion but declined 8%. China, South Korea, and Australia posted the strongest gains. Africa reached \$260 million, up 30%, with upstream ag marketplace and fintech platforms continuing to connect smallholders to inputs and finance.

The opportunities in agrifoodtech remain enormous. And the capital is becoming more disciplined. That's a good thing.

Feedback is always welcome, and get in touch if you want to

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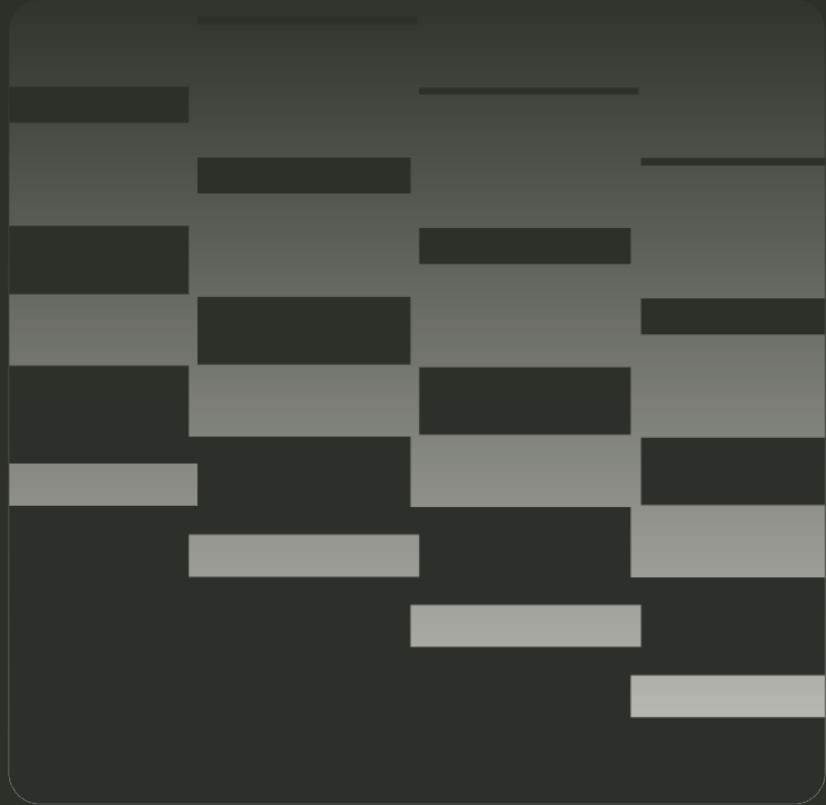
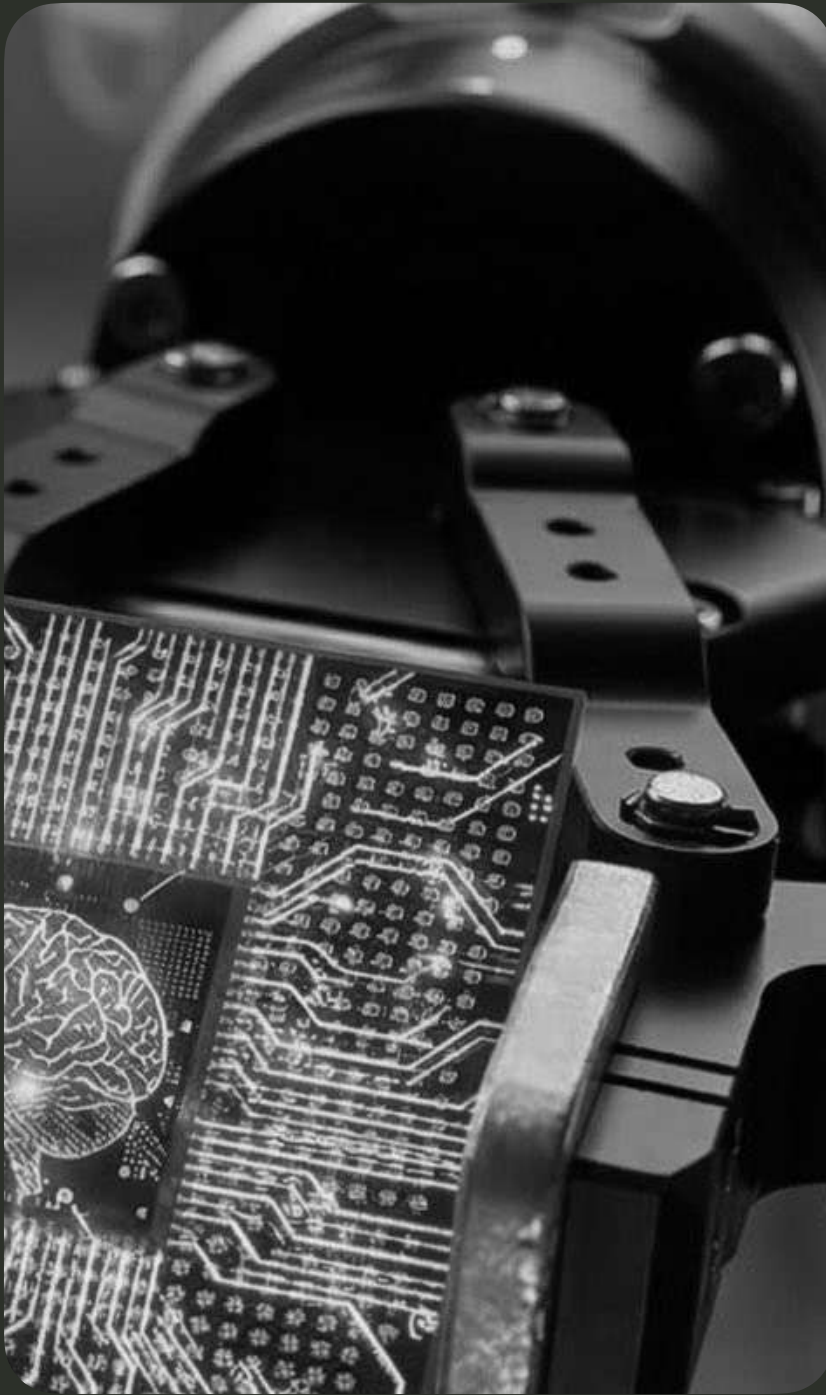
AgFunder is a global venture capital firm investing in deeptech platforms to unlock limiting factors in food, agriculture, human and planetary health. With a readership of millions globally via AgFunderNews, Gaia, our proprietary AI-driven knowledge base of over 50 million startups, and offices in San Francisco, London, and Singapore, AgFunder has unparalleled market intelligence and access.

AFN

AgFunderNews reports on the evolution of the global food and agriculture system. By going beyond the headlines, we analyze the people, companies, and technologies aiming to improve human and planetary health. Publishing daily news, our team of award-winning journalists delivers in-depth insights on the growing foodtech, agtech, and climate tech industries.



FMO, the Dutch entrepreneurial development bank, supports sustainable private sector growth by investing in ambitious projects and entrepreneurs. The FMO Ventures Program, co-funded by the Dutch Ministry of Foreign Affairs and the European Union, focuses on fintech, access to energy, and agrifoodtech.



GUADALUPE MURGA SYLVARUM





LOÏC ROCH ATINARY

Key insights 2025

Total funding

\$16.2 billion

in 2025

(-3% YOY)

Total upstream funding

\$9 billion

in 2025

(+8% YOY)



Top category

eGrocery

\$2.1 BILLION FUNDING

(-23% YOY)

Top upstream category

Bioenergy & Biomaterials

\$1.8 BILLION FUNDING

(+13% YOY)

Biggest deal

Wonder \$600m

Series D (USA)

ONLINE RESTAURANTS
+ MEAL MARKETPLACES

Biggest upstream deal

Samunnati \$267m

Debt (India)

AG MARKETPLACES + FINTECH



10 years of global agrifoodtech

2025

Upstream

+7% YoY

\$9B VS \$8.3B

Deals

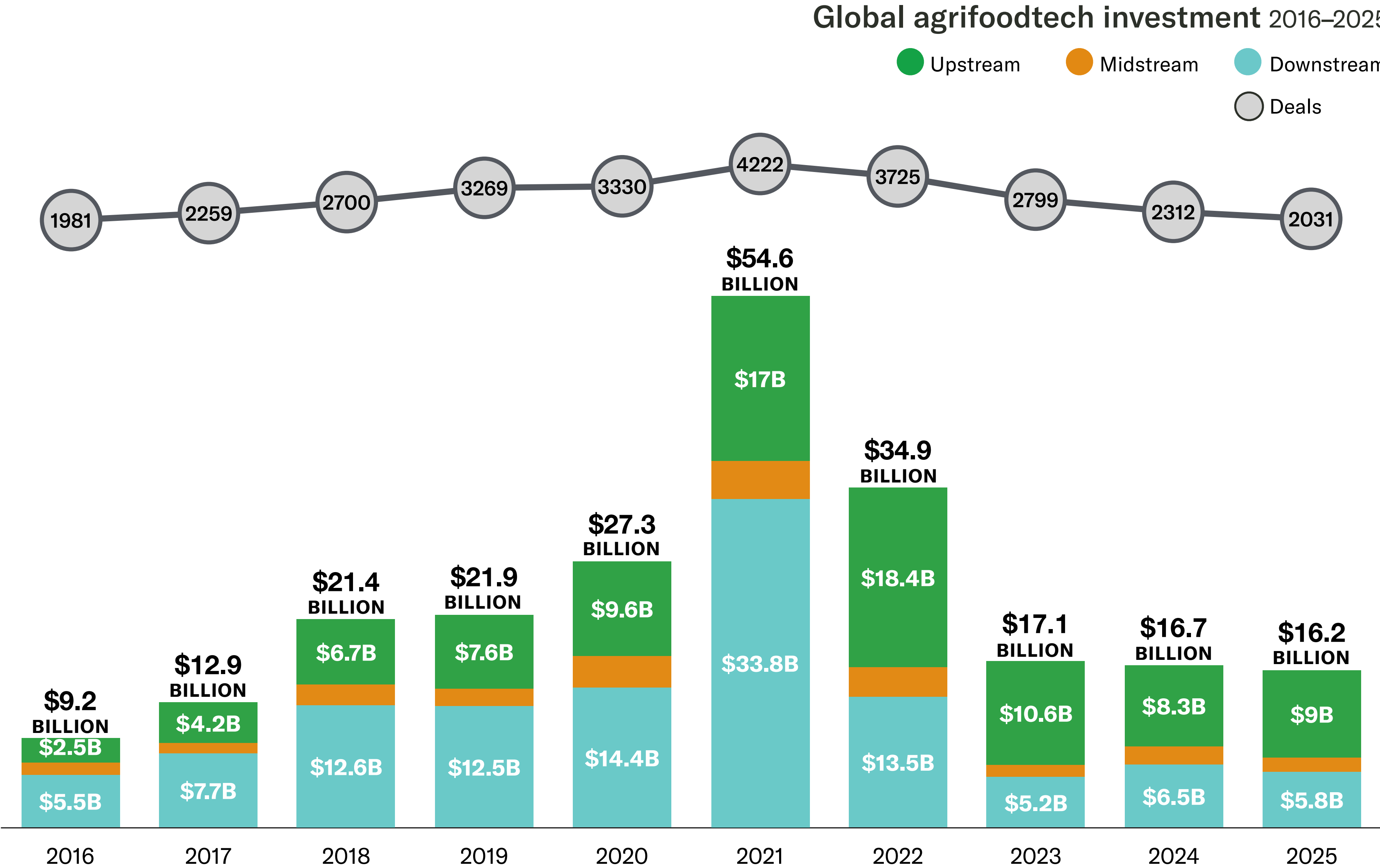
-12.2% YoY

2031 VS 2312

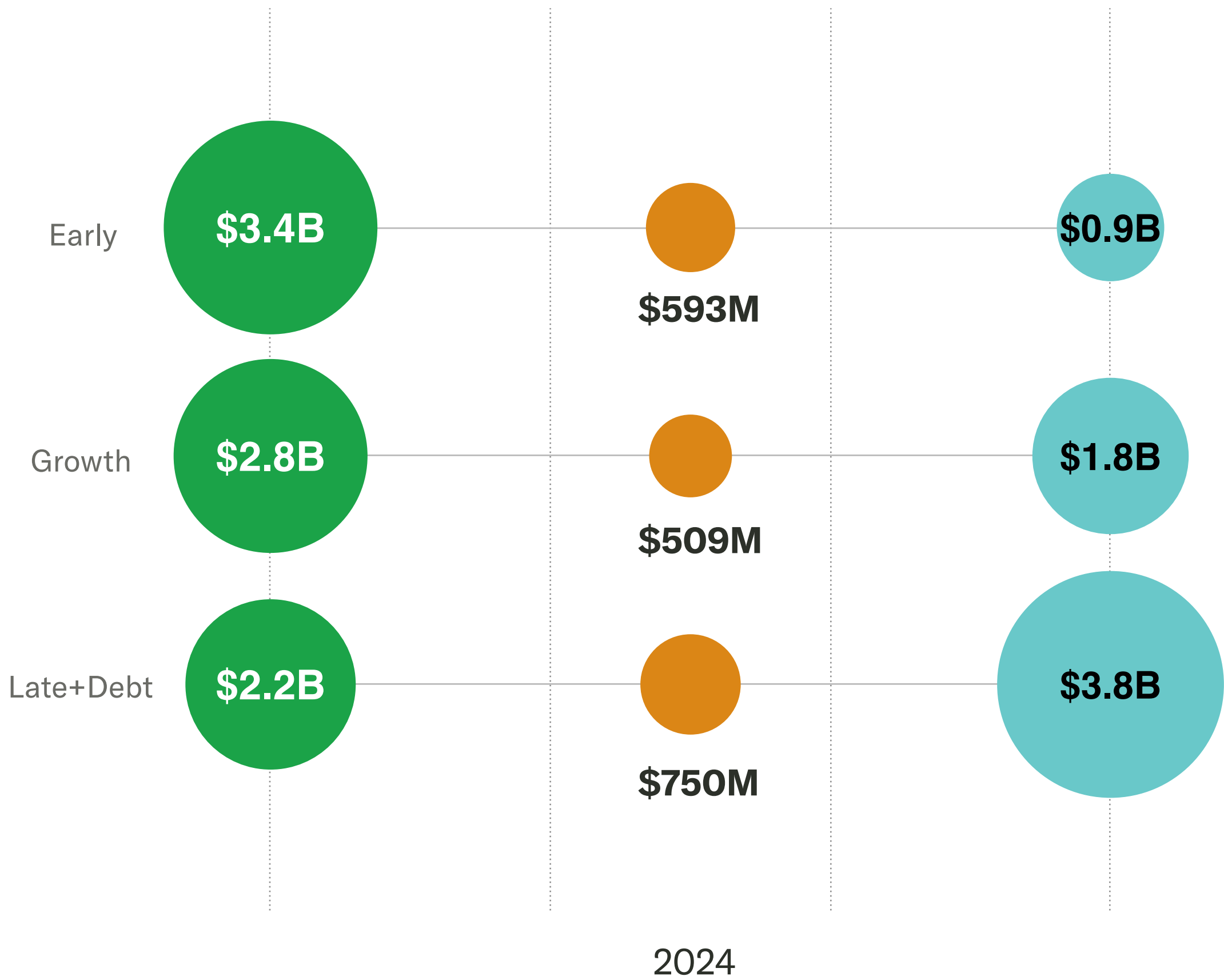
Median deal size

+6.7% YoY

\$2.3M VS \$2.2M

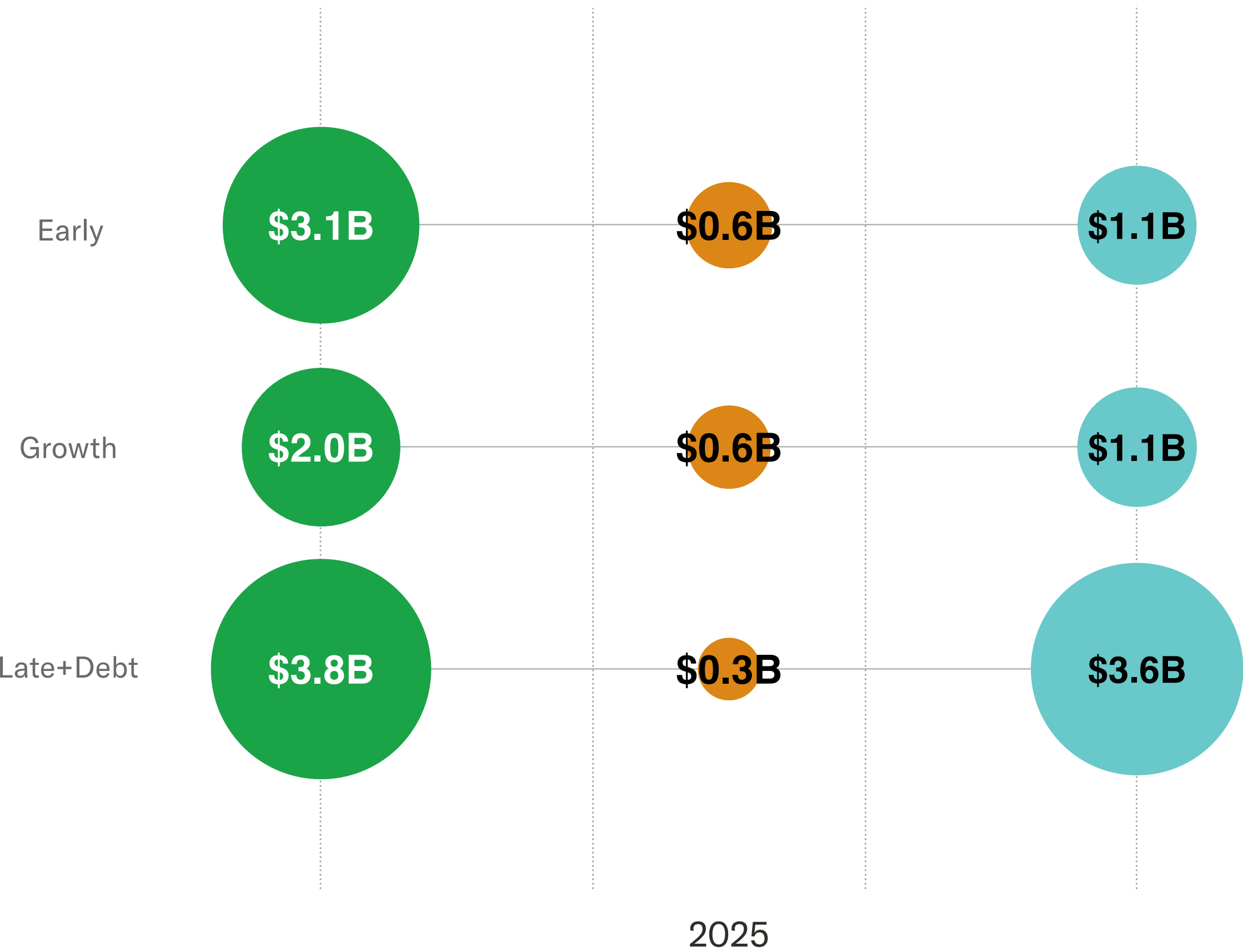


Global agrifoodtech funding by supply chain



Global agrifoodtech investment by stage 2024 v 2025

Upstream Midstream Downstream

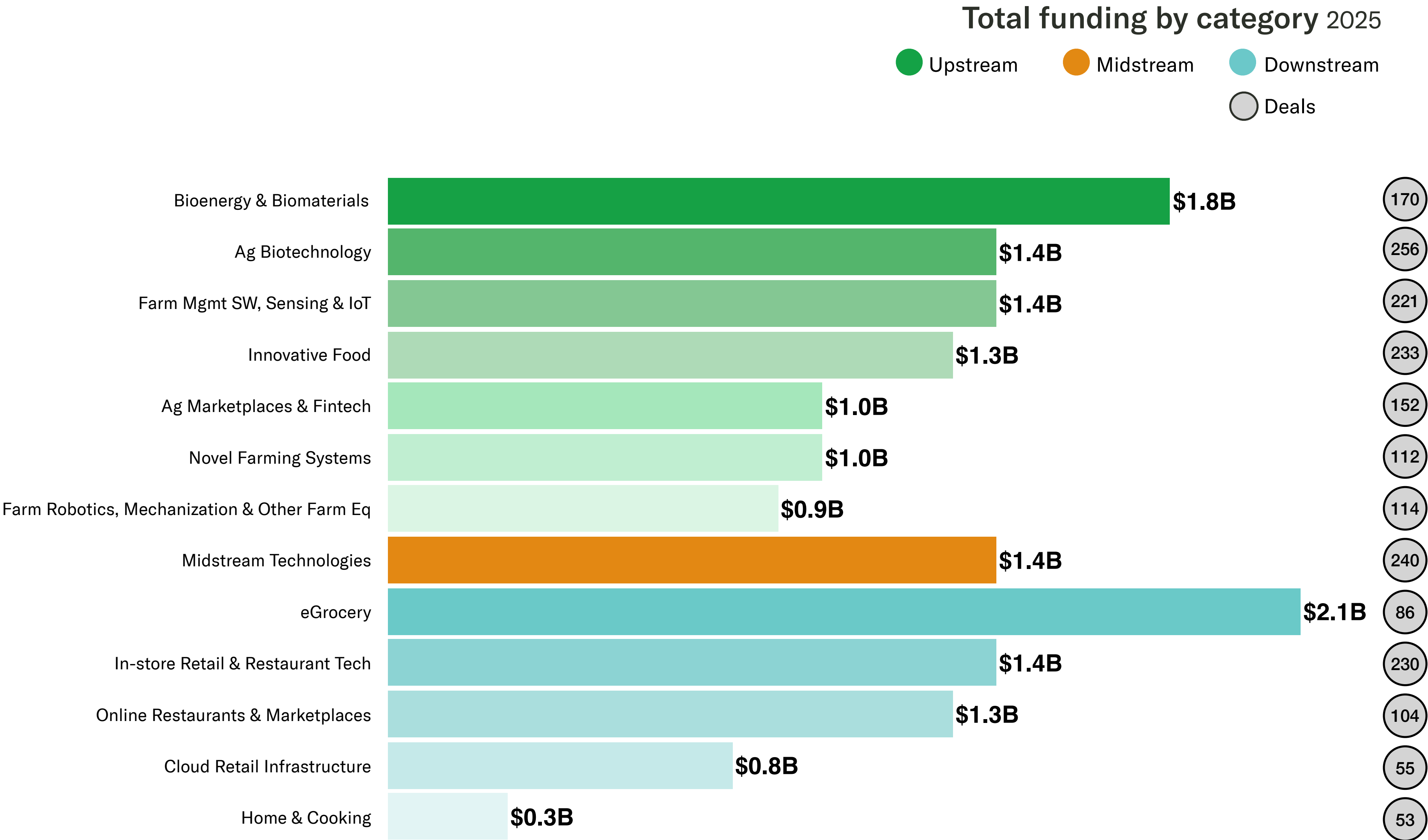


Global agrifoodtech investment by category

The investment narrative is shifting from funding would-be unicorns to, as one investor put it, "building for unit economics, not hype."

Upstream late- and debt-stage funding jumped 73% YoY, from \$2.2 billion in 2024 to \$3.8 billion in 2025. This largely explains why upstream totals grew despite falling deal counts and flat early-stage funding. Chestnut Carbon, Cambrian Innovation, and Inari all pulled in large late rounds.

Elsewhere, France’s Ecorobotix raised \$105 million in Series D funding, while South Korean ag autonomy company GINT closed nearly \$100 million in Series C funding.



Large deal compression

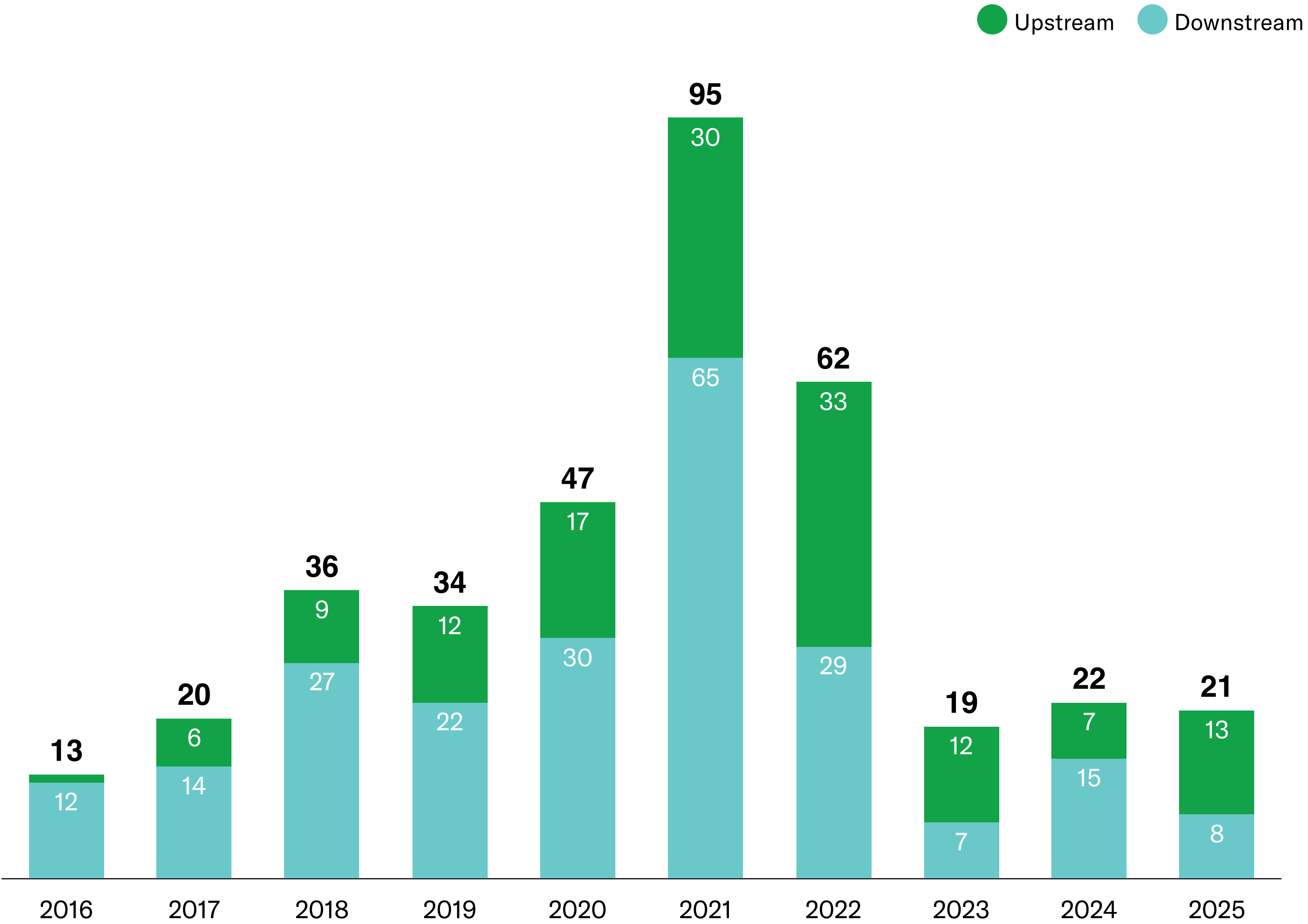
Agrifoodtech’s largest deals have typically gone to downstream startups, with the uptick of deals over \$100 million in 2020 and 2021 almost entirely attributed to food delivery startups during the Covid-19 era. These included the whopping \$3 billion Series D for China eGrocer Xingsheng Youxuan in 2021.

Since then, the funding ceiling has dropped by 80%, while the average size of the largest deals has shrunk. In 2025, these were 35% smaller than 2021's top-tier deals.

At the same time, an impressive lineup of upstream startups raised over \$100 million in 2025, from an Indian ag marketplace and supply chain player to firms in carbon removal, gene editing, and bio-electrochemistry production from wastewater.

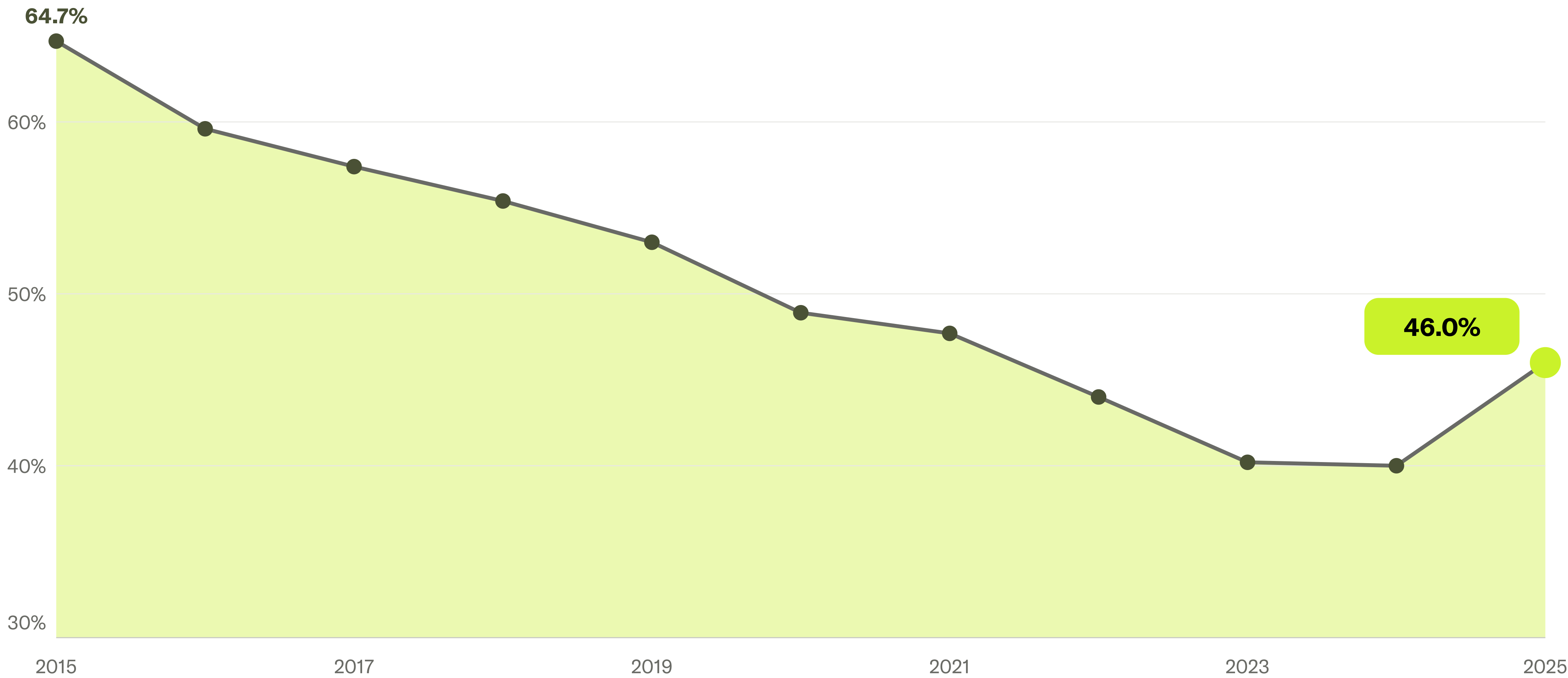
Investors interviewed said they are now focused on clear ROI, credible paths to scale, and smaller ticket sizes versus "chasing moonshots."

Number of deals closed over \$100m 2016-2025



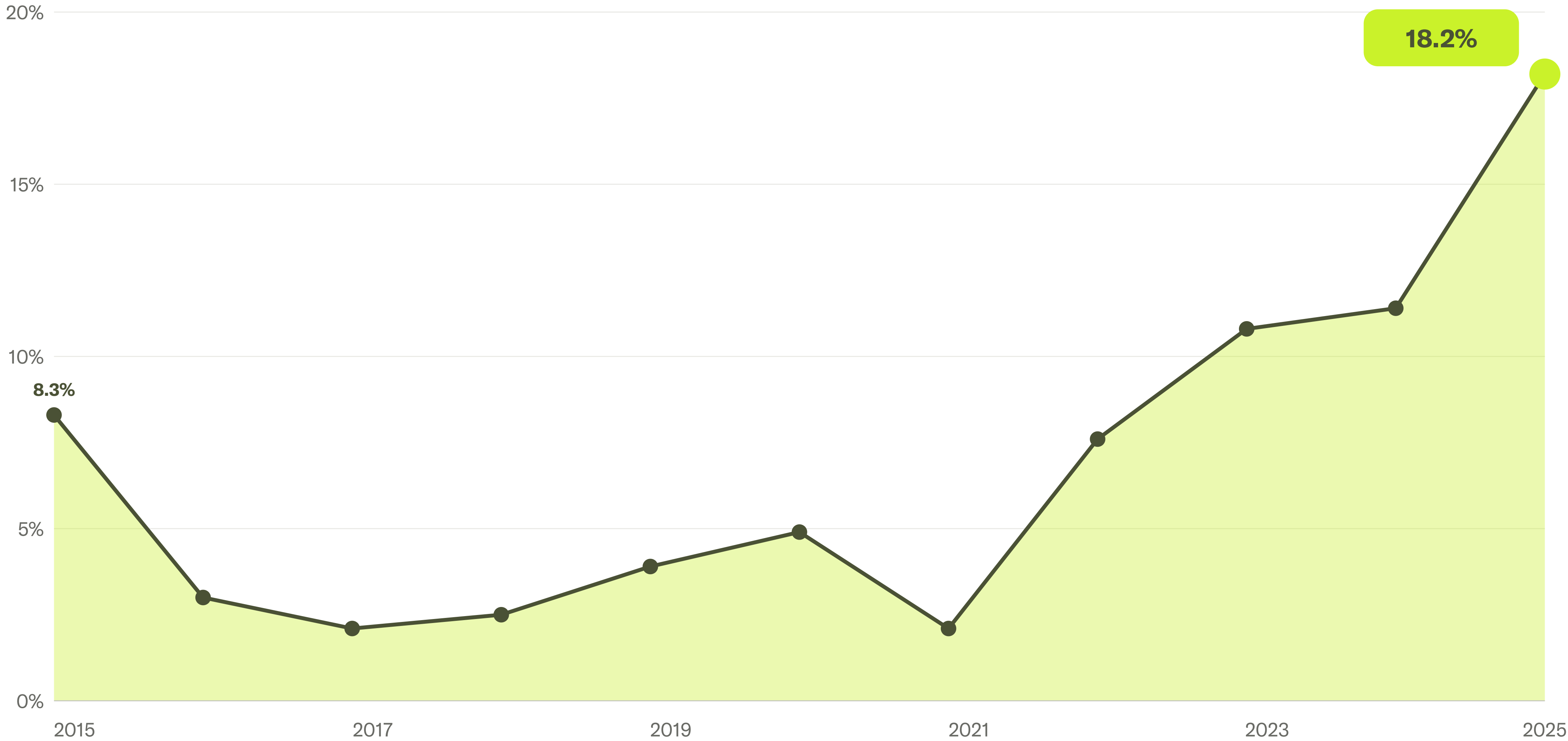
New logos in the dealflow 2015-2025

Share of deals from first-time-funded companies 2015-2025



Debt rounds share of total funding 2015-2025

Share of investment from debt instruments USD \$ 2015-2025



The agrifoodtech discount

Agrifoodtech rounds cost significantly less than US software at every stage. At Seed stage, it's a 75% discount; at Series A, it's 42%. The pattern holds through to Series D.

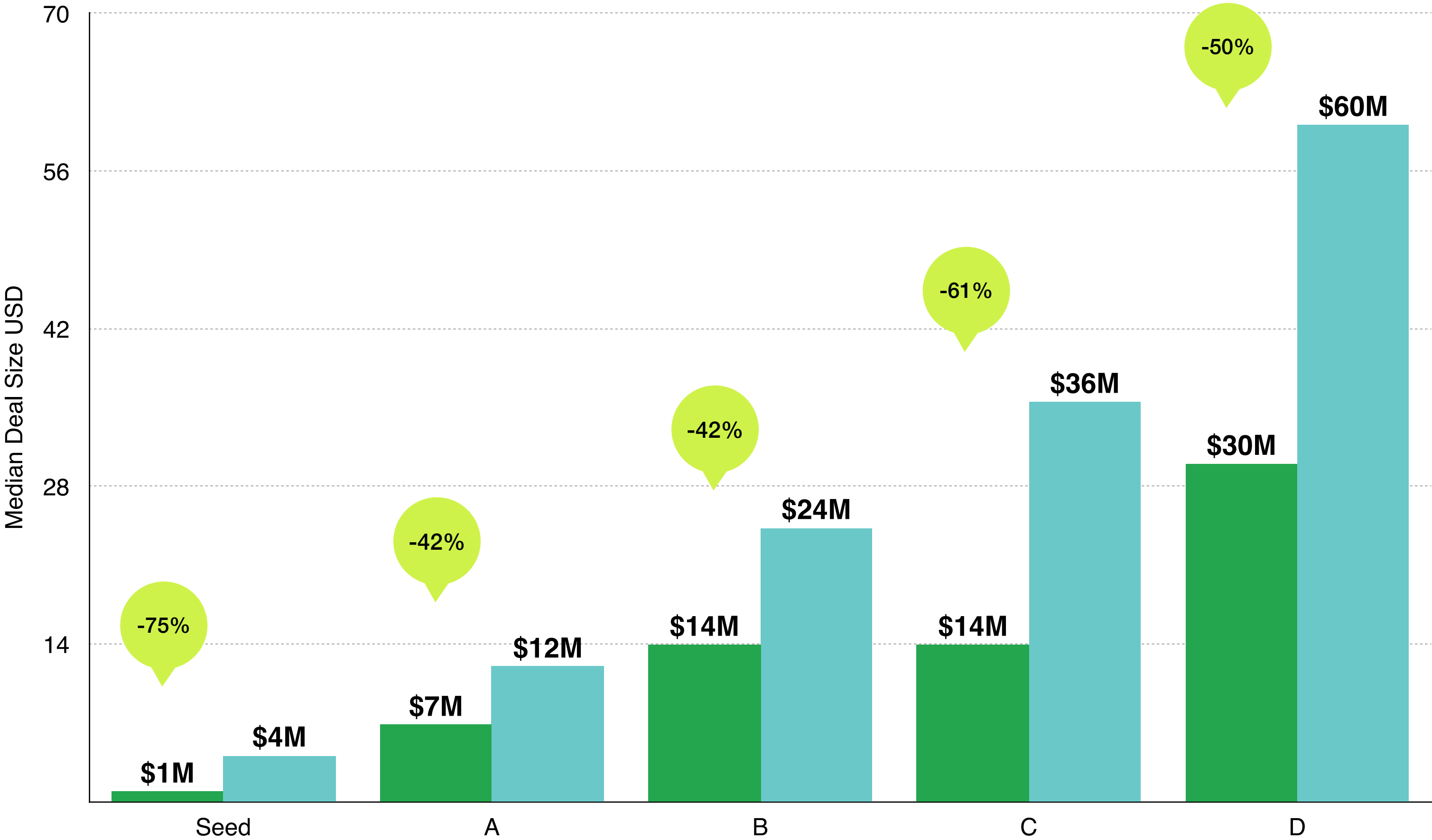
For investors, this is a structural advantage. Lower entry prices mean more ownership per dollar deployed, longer runway per round, and less capital required to reach meaningful milestones.

Agrifoodtech companies are also building against physical constraints, such as soil, biology, supply chains, that create natural defensibility. Software markets get crowded fast.

Is agrifoodtech where enterprise software was 15 years ago: underfunded relative to the market opportunity, with fewer competing term sheets at each stage?

Median deal size by stage 2025

Agrifoodtech US Software*



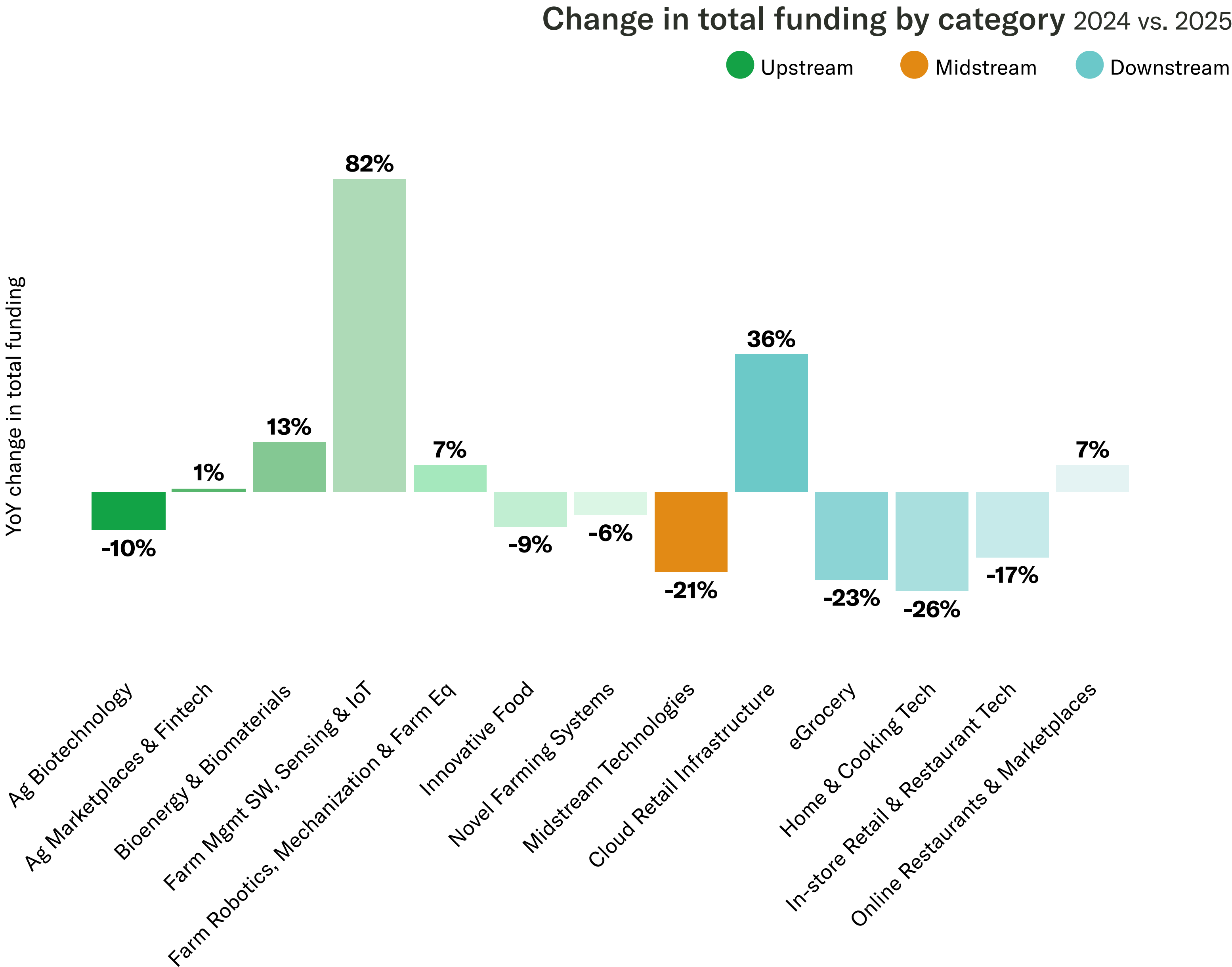
*US software medians from Carta 2025 data.

Global agrifoodtech investment by category

Despite a decline in investment totals, Midstream garnered the most deals of any category, with 240. Seed-stage deals made up the majority of investments.

Meanwhile, funding to upstream categories appears to be stabilizing after across-the-board declines in 2024. Yet a handful of large deals pushed the totals up as deal count continued to decline across all upstream categories except novel farming systems.

Farm Mgmt SW, Sensing & IoT jump in 2025 is a case in point, with carbon project data developer Chestnut Carbon and virtual livestock fencing company Halter raising \$370 million and \$100 million, respectively.



Top agrifoodtech deals 2025

eGrocery maintained its lead in 2025, despite declining deal sizes. Online restaurants raised \$1.3 billion at a small year-over-year increase, yet Wonder’s Series D is 80% smaller than agrifoodtech's largest round in 2021.

Carbon project developer Chestnut Carbon is largely responsible for the Farm Mgmt SW, Sensing & IoT category's strong showing in 2025; the company raised \$370 across two separate rounds.

Top-funded global agrifoodtech companies 2025

	COMPANY	TOTAL \$	COUNTRY	CATEGORY	STAGE
1		600.0M	United States	Online Restaurants & Marketplaces	D
2		495.4M	Netherlands	eGrocer	Late
3		450.0M	India	eGrocer	Late
4		267.4M	India	Ag Marketplaces & Fintech	Debt
5		250.0M	United States	Online Restaurants & Marketplaces	Debt
6		250.0M	United States	eGrocer	Late
7		210.0M	United States	Farm Mgmt SW, Sensing & IoT	Debt
8		173.1M	India	eGrocer	Late
9		160.0M	United States	Farm Mgmt SW, Sensing & IoT	B
10		150.0M	United States	Bioenergy & Biomaterials	Debt

Top 2025 deals by stage

Seed stage deals 2025

COMPANY	\$ TOTAL	COUNTRY
 BLU EPRI INT	60M	US
 nortian	41M	US
 Liberation Bioindustries	31.5M	US
 THEKER	21M	Spain
 a.k.a FOODS	17M	Israel

Series A deals 2025

COMPANY	\$ TOTAL	COUNTRY
 BOT IN KIT	100M	China
 bioleum	85M	US
 David	75M	US
 TECHCOOP COOPERATION & GROWTH	70M	Vietnam
 BLK	63M	UK

Series B deals 2025

COMPANY	\$ TOTAL	COUNTRY
 chestnut	160M	US
 Tidal Vision	140M	US
 chestnut	90M	US
 Coco Robotics	80M	US
 AIL	68M	Japan

Series C deals 2025

COMPANY	\$ TOTAL	COUNTRY
 Owner	120M	US
 DEXORY	100M	UK
 GINT	98M	S. Korea
 Redlin	70M	China
 Haigistar	67M	China

Series D deals 2025

COMPANY	\$ TOTAL	COUNTRY
 Wonder	600M	US
 Jumbotail	120M	India
 ecorobotix	105M	Switzerland
 Halter	100M	New Zealand
 SOLINFTEC	60M	Brazil

Late-stage deals 2025

COMPANY	\$ TOTAL	COUNTRY
 PIC NiC	495M	Netherlands
 zepto	450M	India
 gopuff	250M	US
 blinkit	173M	India
 INARI	144M	US

As the food delivery mega-deal era fades, a greater percentage of upstream startups account for agrifoodtech's top deals at most stages, with multiple companies from ag biotech, farm robotics, farm management tools, and bioenergy and biomaterials startups.

Startup profile - Lumi AI

Canada-based Lumi AI offers a chat-based agentic data analyst that uncovers hidden optimization opportunities across ERPs and databases. It's aim is to power smarter supply chain, distribution and customer operations.

What challenge does Lumi AI solve?

Despite millions invested in dashboards and data infrastructure, business teams remain constrained by predefined views of their operations. Non-obvious risks, inefficiencies, and value drivers go undiscovered because no one knows to look for them.

By combining enterprise-grade security, rich business context, and agentic workflows, Lumi lets teams ask plain-language questions and autonomously surfaces insights that traditional BI tools miss.

Mid-to-large enterprises, including global retailers and consulting partners, use Lumi in production to uncover multi-million-dollar opportunities across sales, procurement, and supply chain operations.

What were Lumi AI's highlights in 2025?

We closed our \$3.7 million seed round and assembled a senior team across engineering and GTM.

We deployed Lumi in production with paying F100 enterprises and consulting partners, using deep, structured feedback loops to materially accelerate product iteration.

We also built repeatable, non-founder-led pipeline generation through sales and marketing automation and improved conversion.

Plans for 2026?

2026 is about scaling with intent.

Our bottom-of-funnel pipeline includes highly recognizable enterprise logos expected to convert in the near term, while top-of-funnel growth is increasingly driven by durable, repeatable GTM

infrastructure rather than founder-led effort.

On the product side, upcoming capabilities such as self-service, private tenants, and flexible data hosting expand both TAM and ACVs. In parallel, we are introducing the next wave of innovation with proactive autonomous insights and alerting, extending Lumi beyond analytics toward execution.

We are no longer testing whether this works. We are scaling a model that already does.

For investors who can help accelerate distribution, partnerships, and category leadership as this compounds, we are actively engaging in conversations.

[Disclosure: AgFunder is an investor in Lumi AI.]



LUMI AI COFOUNDERS TUDOR BOIANGIU AND IBRAHIM ASHQAR

Mid-to-large enterprises, including global retailers and consulting partners, use Lumi in production to uncover multi-million-dollar opportunities across sales, procurement, and supply chain operations.

IBRAHIM ASHQAR, LUMI AI CEO

lumi-ai.com »



STEPHEN KLEIN HYPHEN



AFN

**LOUISA BURWOOD-TAYLOR** CCO & HEAD OF INTELLIGENCE

Deeptech in agrifoodtech

Where's the **deeptech** in agrifoodtech?

This year's report includes our first dedicated analysis of deeptech activity within the agrifoodtech investment landscape.

Global food system challenges, from soil degradation and water scarcity to protein supply constraints and pest and disease control, are fundamentally scientific problems calling for deeptech solutions.

While deeptech startups in agrifood have certainly had their fair share of epic failures—typically when scientific and economic timelines were drastically underestimated—consumer-facing, downstream business models, inflated by cheap capital, were hit harder in the recent downturn.

And while modest, investment in upstream agrifoodtech startups increased in 2025. Upstream startups—those operating on the

farm or in food production—account for the vast majority of deeptech dealflow (88%), with Ag Biotech (97% by deal count), Farm Robotics (62%), Novel Farming Systems (46%), and Bioenergy and Biomaterials (45%) leading the pack.

And since the 2021 peak, while total agrifoodtech funding fell 70%, deeptech funding fell 62% versus 73% for non-deeptech.

The advent of agentic AI alongside breakthroughs in synthetic biology, gene editing, molecular discovery, and advanced sensing is compressing R&D cycles that used to take a decade into timelines investors can underwrite.

Gene-edited crop traits are reaching commercialization; precision fermentation economics are improving; satellite and sensor fusion now

deliver field-level intelligence that was theoretical five years ago.

The gap between lab and market is shrinking, and capital is slowly starting to follow.

Deeptech's share of funding has fluctuated between 21% and 32% over the past decade, and similarly, its share of deals has climbed steadily from 22% to 32%.

Seed stage investor appetite also appears to be strong, with rounds closing at a 78% premium over non-deeptech equivalents. Hopefully, this signals a growing pipeline of science-led companies entering the market.

Breaking down deeptech funding by stage, geography, and category, we hope to shed some light on where the capital is going, where the gaps remain, and why we believe this is the most consequential layer of the agrifoodtech stack.

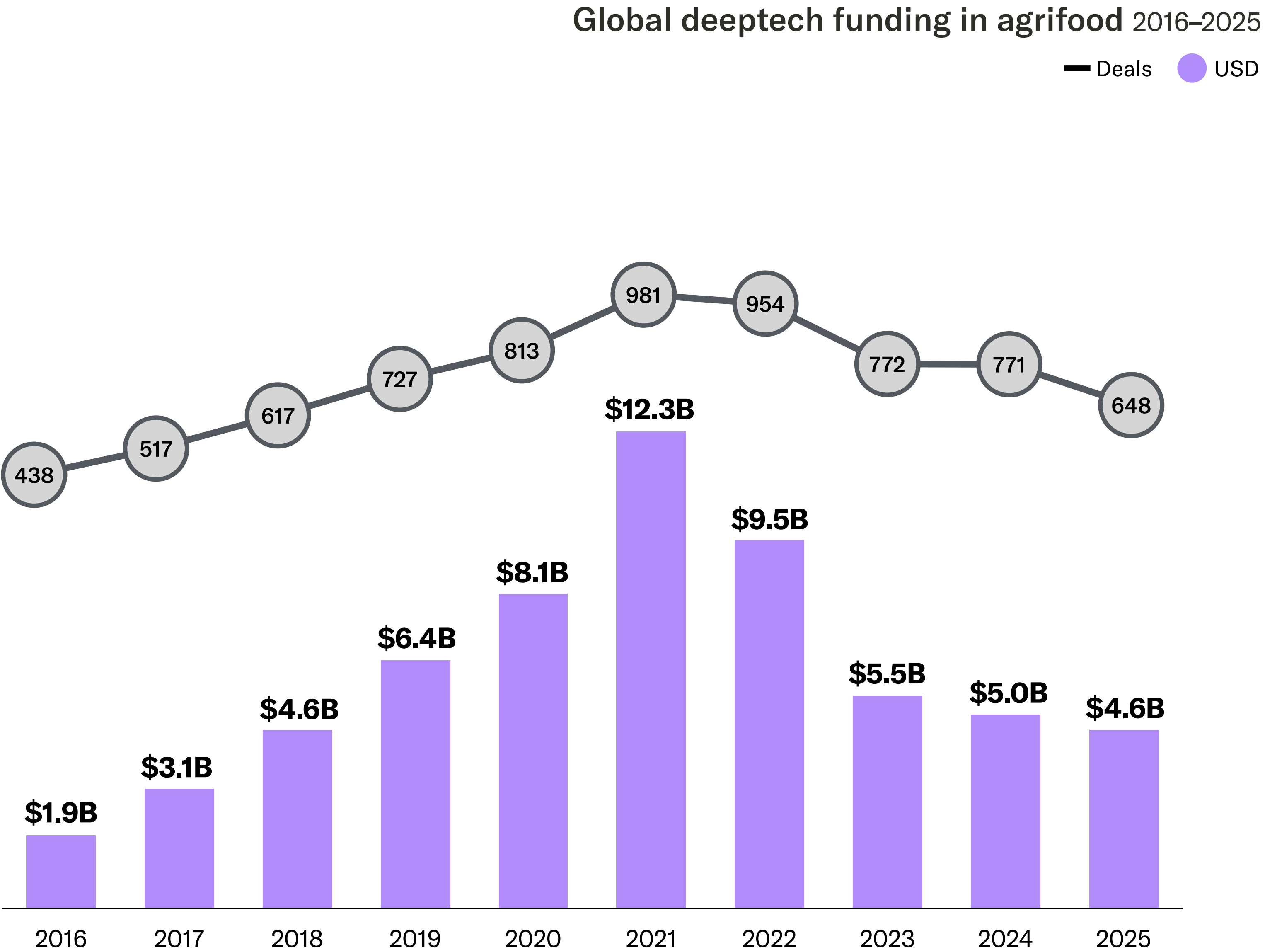
10 years of **deeptech** in agrifoodtech

We classify companies as deeptech if their core competitive advantage is rooted in scientific or engineering innovation. (For more on the methodology see p. 63.)

Deeptech’s share of agrifood funding has fluctuated between 21% and 32% over the past decade, and similarly, its share of deals has climbed steadily from 22% to 32%.

Ag Biotech raised the largest amount of deeptech funding in 2025, followed by Bioenergy & Biomaterials and Farm Robotics.

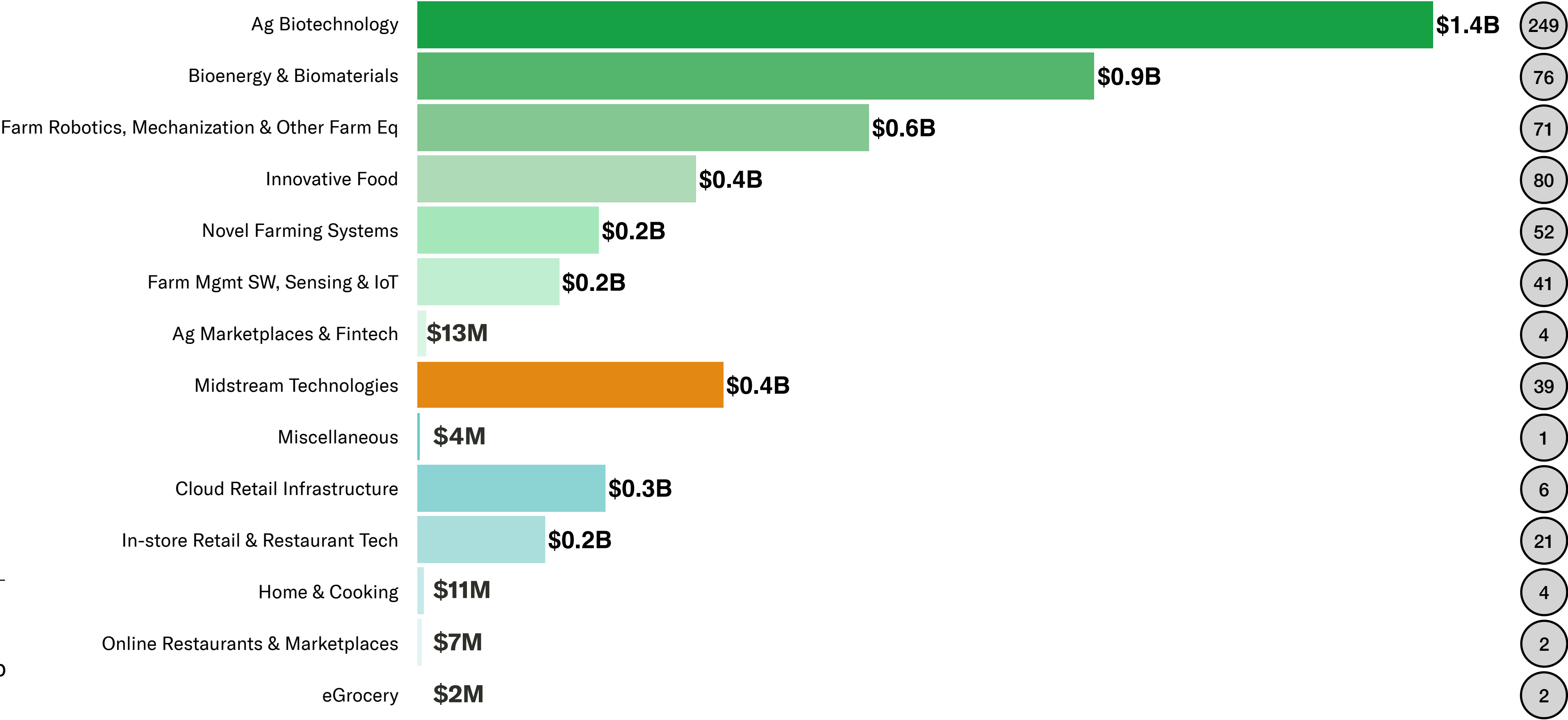
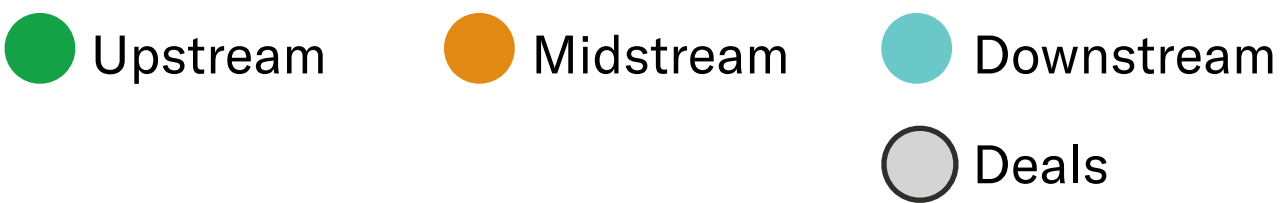
AgFunder made nine deeptech investments in 2025; see p. 30 for more information.



Deeptech in agrifoodtech

Upstream categories dominate

Total deeptech funding by category 2025



Upstream categories dominate deeptech funding. Ag Biotechnology and Bioenergy & Biomaterials made up almost 50% of total deeptech funding within agrifoodtech in 2025.

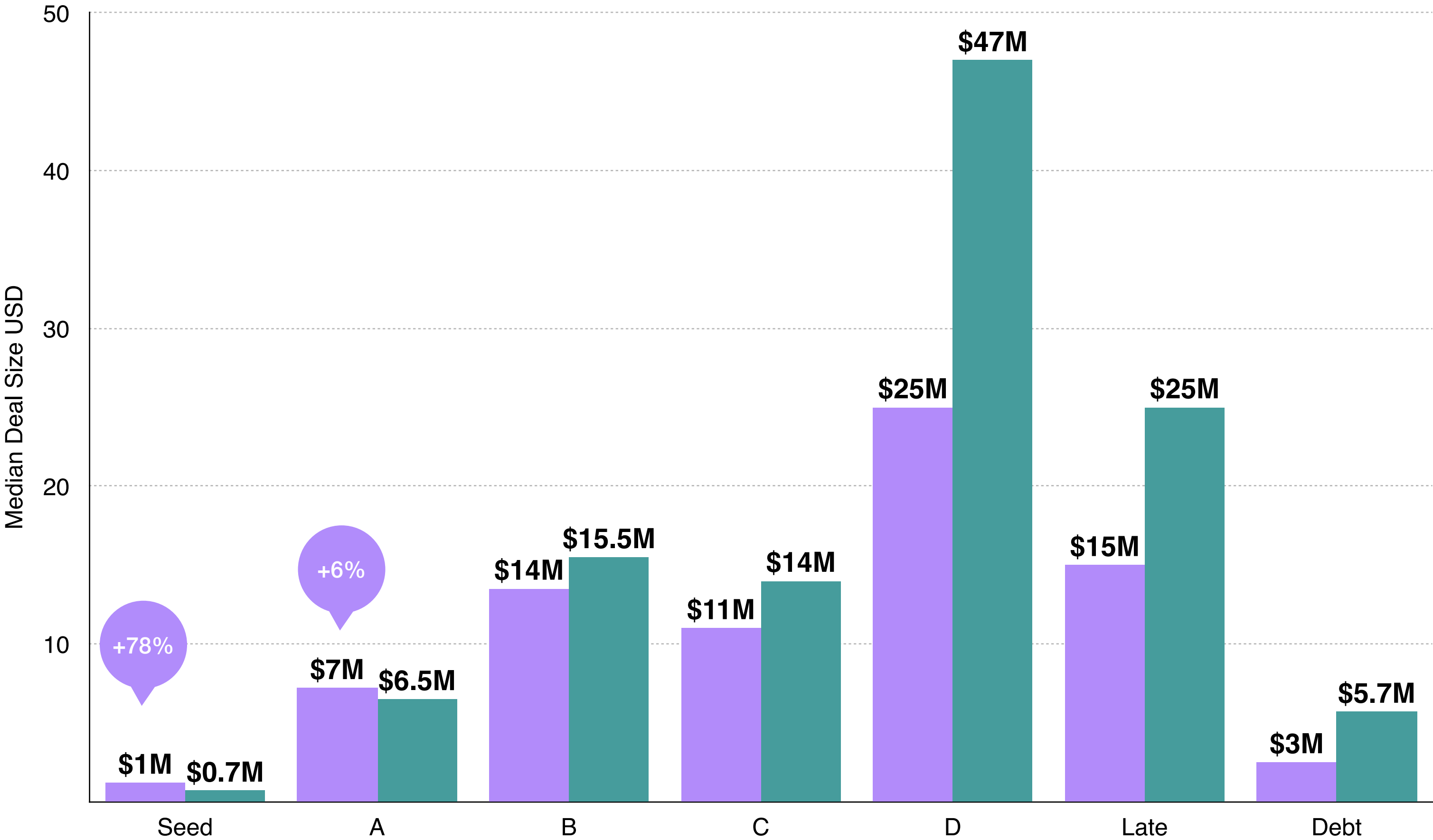
The Deeptech premium

When does it appear?

Deeptech agrifood startups are raising larger rounds at the earlier stages, but that tapers off from Series B onwards as later-stage rounds skew towards companies that have revenues. Similarly for Debt, we do not see much capital committed to unproven, uncommercialized business models.

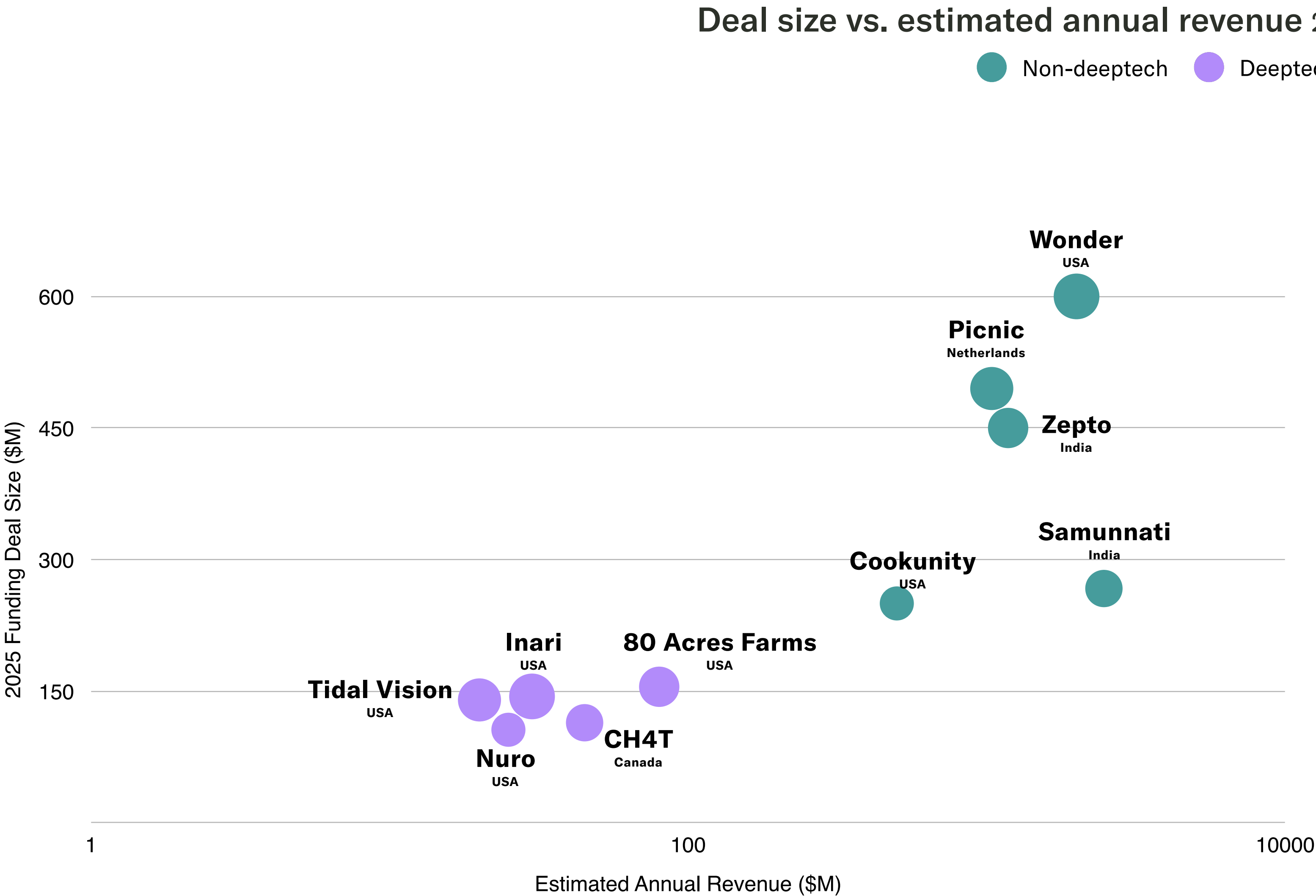
Median deal size by stage 2025

Non-deeptech Deeptech



Top 10 funded companies in 2025

Deals sizes correlate with revenues, which are still subdued for many deeptech startups, even those at the later stages like those pictured here. Still, patient investors continue to back these companies that have spent years developing IP in-house, despite growing investor demand for revenues.



Large deals compression

Deeptech falls off >\$200M

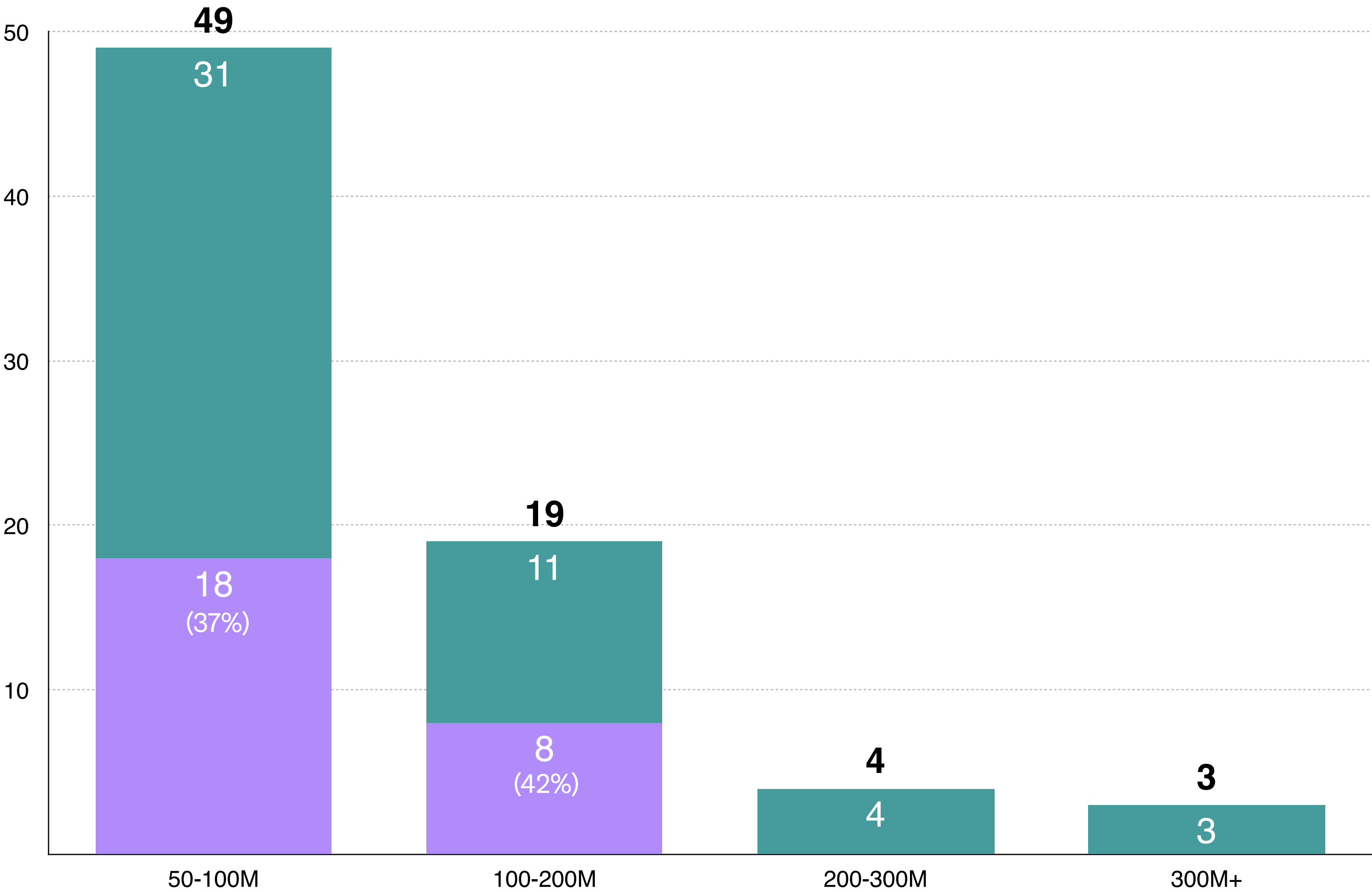
The largest deeptech deal in 2025 was \$144 million (for gene editing company Inari). No deeptech company broke \$200 million, while seven non-deeptech deals did.

It reflects a rational correction; five of 33 deeptech companies that raised \$200 million-plus rounds between 2019 and 2022 have hard-failed, all in Novel Farming or Innovative Food, according to data from Eugen Kaprov’s The New Bioeconomy newsletter.

Until the boom-era bets in those deeptech categories prove out commercially, growth investors remain cautious about writing large checks against science risk.

Number of deals closed above \$50m 2025

Non-deeptech Deeptech



Deeptech in agrifoodtech

China and UK have the edge

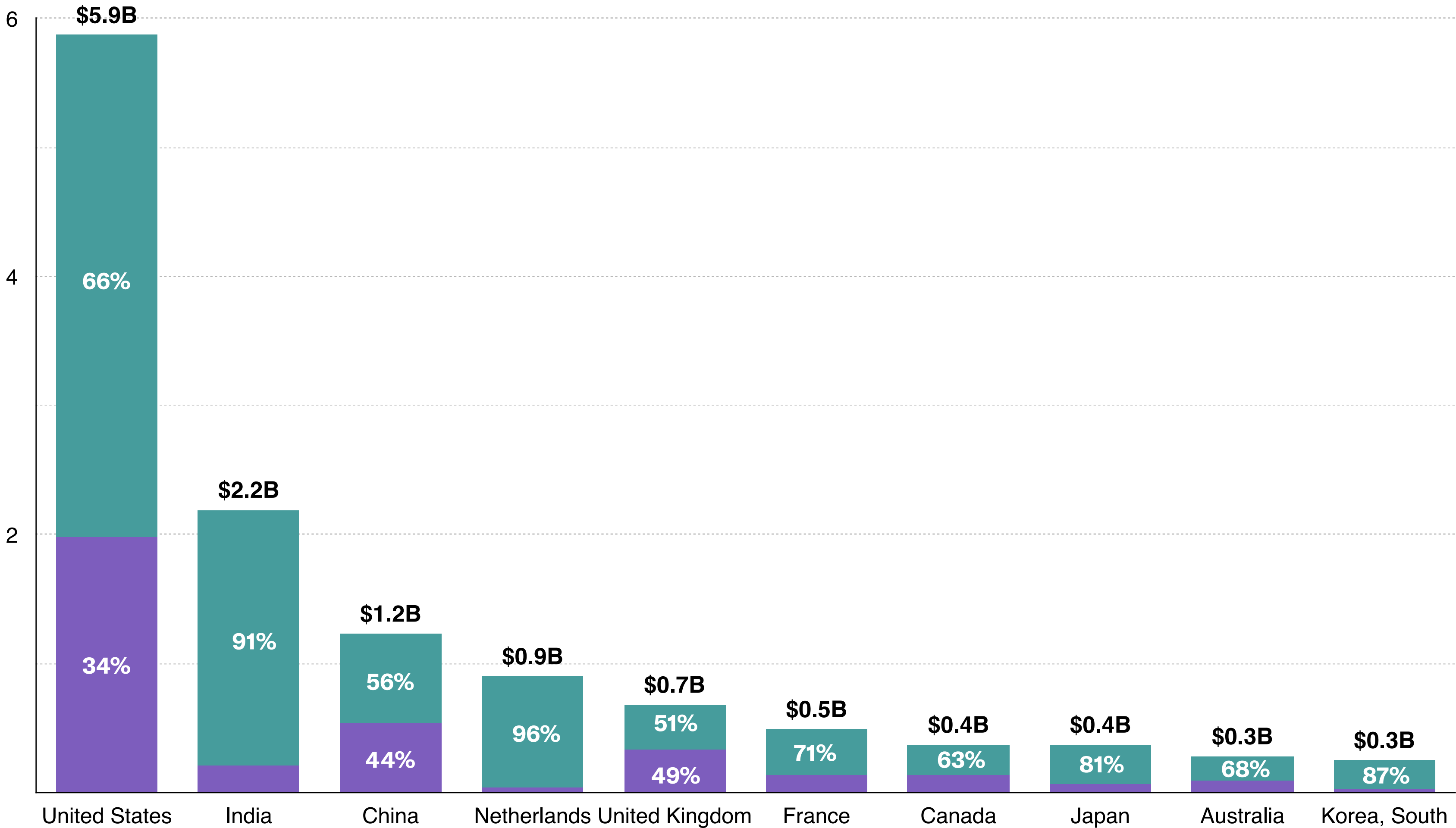
China and the UK allocate the highest share of agrifood funding to deeptech: 44% and 49%, respectively.

China's edge comes from state-backed capital, gene-editing policy priorities, and over 70% of global fermentation capacity. The UK sends 49% of its \$685 million to deeptech in the highest ratio among the top-10 markets. Academic spin-outs, focused VCs, and government R&D incentives fuel the pipeline.

Smaller markets with high deeptech concentration often offer lower entry prices and less competition for term sheets.

Agrifoodtech funding by top countries 2025

Non-deeptech Deeptech



Deeptech special report



ATINARY COFOUNDERS ROCH LOÏC & HERMANN TRIBUKAIT

Rewriting the century-old R&D playbook for the AI era

The world's most critical challenges—from food security and the energy transition to human health and climate resilience—are accelerating rapidly. The R&D methods tasked with solving them are not, writes Jennifer Marston.

In the race to find the next fuel cell, sugar alternative, herbicide, or packaging material, the traditional R&D process is a decades-long endeavor with abysmally low success rates. With the success of entire industries now reliant on delivering new, resilient solutions at scale and speed, this costly, slow-moving paradigm is finally starting to fade into obsolescence.

Simultaneously, a mix of AI, robotics, and partnership models is building a new paradigm, ushering in new opportunities for major industries, agrifood included, in the process.

The fast lane to scientific discovery

“Scientists spend roughly 80% of their time optimizing things, so there is no creation, no creativity, just fine-tuning,” says Atinary CTO Loïc Roch. “Scientists should spend 80% of their time thinking about what to tackle, why this problem, and let a machine take care of the rest.”

Atinary is among a handful of startups employing AI and automation to change this.

Behind Atinary’s platform is a simple idea: an automated lab that learns from itself. It designs its own experiments, runs them, analyzes the results and updates its understanding of the problem based on those results. Rinse and repeat 24/7, 365 days per year.

There are potentially millions of formulas, ingredients, temperatures, and conditions to test. Falcon AI, Atinary’s proprietary optimization algorithm, uses Bayesian Optimization to map out experiments that have already run, what’s working, and, based on that information, what experiment to run next.

The idea is for scientists to leverage the tool to find the best results in as few experiments as possible.

Critically, scientists don’t need a degree in machine learning to use Atinary’s tools, which were designed with a “no code” approach in mind.

A reduced timeline here is striking. Developments that historically took years can be compressed into a few months.

Deeptech special report

As one example, Atinary worked with ETH Zurich's SwissCat+ initiative to identify the best catalyst for converting carbon dioxide into methanol. "Typically, to do this conversion the regular way would take roughly 100 years of research," claims Roch. Atinary accomplished it in six weeks.

More recently Atinary worked with ABB Robotics and others to build a fully autonomous Self Driving Lab (SDL), which it unveiled this month in Boston, Massachusetts.

Robotics in the lab isn't a new concept. However, combining Atinary's software with robotics (along with contributions from Mettler-Toledo and Agilent, both key players in lab technology) turns experiments into fully autonomous, closed-loop cycles, with AI deciding what to test and robots physically carrying the work out.

Roch says Atinary's SDL can run between 200 and 400 experiments per day, generating more data than a PhD student would churn out over the course of a typical five-year degree program.

The goal of this collaboration is not to replace scientists, Roch stresses. It's about helping them spend 80% of their time deciding which problem to solve and not on every last detail of how to do it.

A new blueprint for corporate R&D

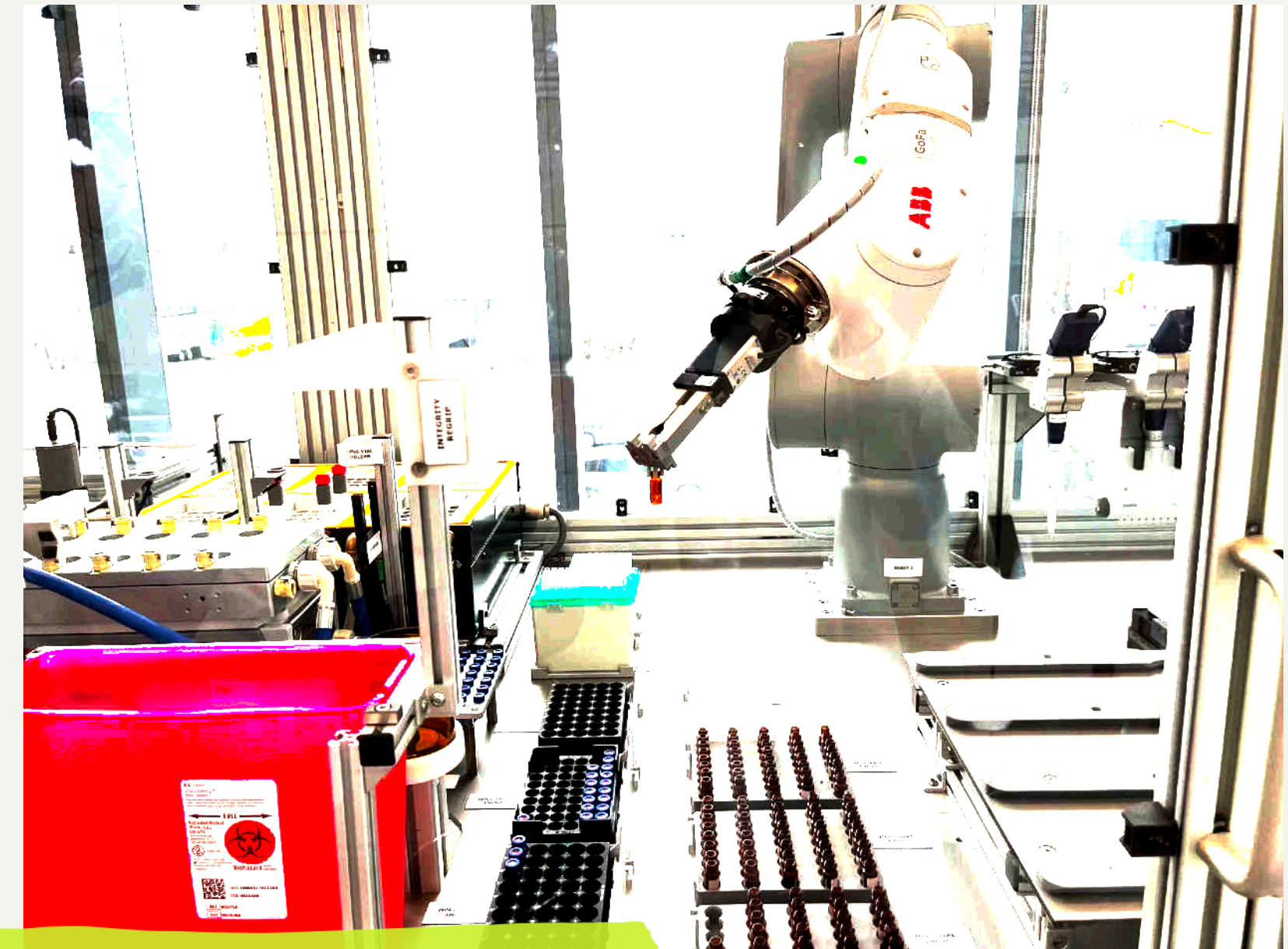
In agriculture, new product development has long needed an R&D makeover. Drought-resistant corn, cleaner label alternatives to synthetic dyes, and better routes to biofuels are in demand. But these and other innovations require years-long development cycles and quite a bit of money.

In response, large agribusinesses are now leveraging AI and other tools in an effort to speed up new product discovery and synthesis, and work with younger, more agile startups to implement new ideas.

"We're seeing the strongest impact where complexity, uncertainty and scale intersect," says Renee Boerefijn, senior director for R&D at [Cargill](#), tells AgFunderNews.

Across Cargill's portfolio, ingredient formulation and sensory optimization are key areas in need of R&D innovation, says Boerefijn. Here, predictive modeling helps teams understand ingredient behavior across multiple applications.

"By integrating sensory science with AI and ingredient and component models, we can predict



ATINARY'S SELF-DRIVING LABS IN BOSTON, MA

preference, reduce reformulation cycles, and work on innovations that help meet expectations around taste, texture, and familiarity—which is critical for repeat purchase."

Like Atinary, Cargill says it is using AI in R&D to augment rather than replace human input.

"AI shortens feedback loops—but human expertise remains central to interpreting results and making decisions," explains Boerefijn. "Speed does not come from automation alone, but from better selection, stronger data foundations, and closer collaboration between customers and Cargill."

Deeptech special report

For example, Cargill has partnered with Voyage Foods to develop chocolate alternative NextCoa.

Voyage provides technology to turn upcycled ingredients into "cocoa-like flavors and textures," while Cargill applies predictive sensory science, formulation expertise, and application know-how.

"Digital tools and AI-driven sensory modelling help both teams assess consumer acceptance and optimize performance much earlier, faster, and more accurately than traditional trial-and-error R&D," says Boerefijn.

“By acting as a connector between startups, scientists, customers, and supply chains, we aim to help turn promising ideas into solutions that work at scale—and ultimately contribute to a more resilient, affordable and sustainable food system.”

AI shortens feedback loops—but human expertise remains central to interpreting results and making decisions.

RENEE BOEREFIJN SENIOR DIRECTOR FOR R&D AT CARGILL

While large corporate efforts like Cargill's drive internal innovation, external partners are also playing a crucial role in accelerating specialized R&D.

CDMOs: Localizing R&D for global success

Even when a company has strong R&D capabilities in-house, pursuing open innovation is worthwhile, as it adds to possible capabilities, solutions, and products, says Gilson Manfio, PhD, head of R&D and innovation at IdeeLab.

As a full-service contract development and manufacturing organization (CDMO), IdeeLab supports other companies in their scientific discovery and production processes.

CDMOs can provide everything from infrastructure (e.g., fermentation tanks) to expertise on regulatory requirements to tools for process optimization and analytical testing. The concept is well known in pharma and biotech and is now making its way into agriculture, too. IdeeLab, for example, focuses specifically on the discovery and production of biological crop protection products.

“The development of biological products via CDMOs is much faster and cheaper,” Manfio tells

AgFunderNews, adding that major benefits of CDMOs can include “a more effective product scope and overall agility in the process.” Right now, IdeeLab works with multinational agribusinesses as well as startups on projects such as the development of metabolite- and peptide-based biologicals.

“We provide solutions from live cell products (live microorganisms or a mixture of different organisms in a product), to next-generation products based on microbial metabolites and effector proteins/peptides, the latter triggering physiological responses in the plant itself, such as defense response and stress response modulation,” notes Manfio.

The company is headquartered in Brazil and focuses its efforts there; its particular CDMO model could be replicated elsewhere in the world in the future, he adds.

[Disclosure: AgFunder is an investor in Atinary.]

Deeptech special report

One major benefit of CDMOs in discovery and development is the ability to account for the necessary biogeographical context—the recognition that crop protection products developed for a temperate environment like the US or Europe won’t likely perform the same way when deployed in the tropics. If an R&D team is based in Switzerland, it needs a local partner in the region in which it intends to sell its products.

“Many companies bring technologies from abroad and launch them in the country, and they don’t perform as well as they did in the original country,” says Manfio.

“We have big agricultural players looking for a local developer so they can [develop and test] with a local developer that can do it faster and more reliably. This brings agility and the possibility of running specific tests with diseases and pests that would not be possible at the client’s R&D laboratory located in the US or Europe.”

Thus, development can be much more efficient if carried out in the region/context where the product will be used.

A new R&D paradigm

While a self-driving lab, R&D at a major agribusiness, and a CDMO for biologicals are distinct from one another, each is a response to the same problem: the tools science has relied on for the past century are no longer sufficient to address the challenges ahead.

Nor is it only a matter of solving today’s problems. As Roch notes, the transformation of R&D through these new technologies could lead to discoveries the scientific community has yet to even consider.

“With time compression like this, think of the discoveries we can make every month, every quarter, every year,” he says.

“We’re at a stage where we have all these technologies. Now we need to make them converge so we can move to the next paradigm, what the next 100 years will look like.”



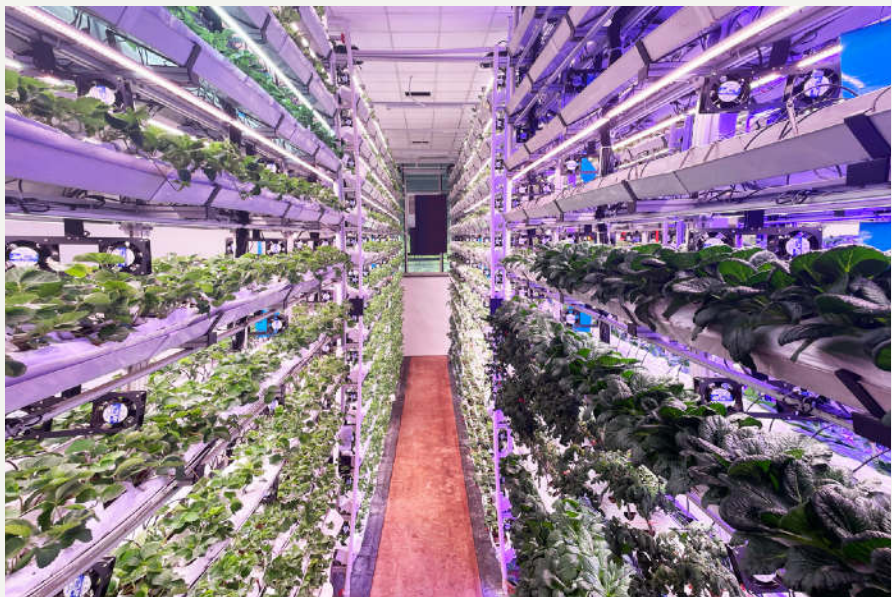
GILSON MANFIO, PHD, HEAD OF R&D AND INNOVATION AT IDEELAB



SIOBHAN COSTER ECLIPSE

AgFunder

Deeptech investments in 2025

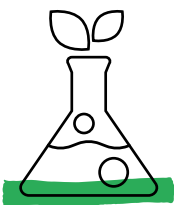




NICOLE ROBINSON LYRO ROBOTICS



AFN



Category spotlight - Ag Biotech

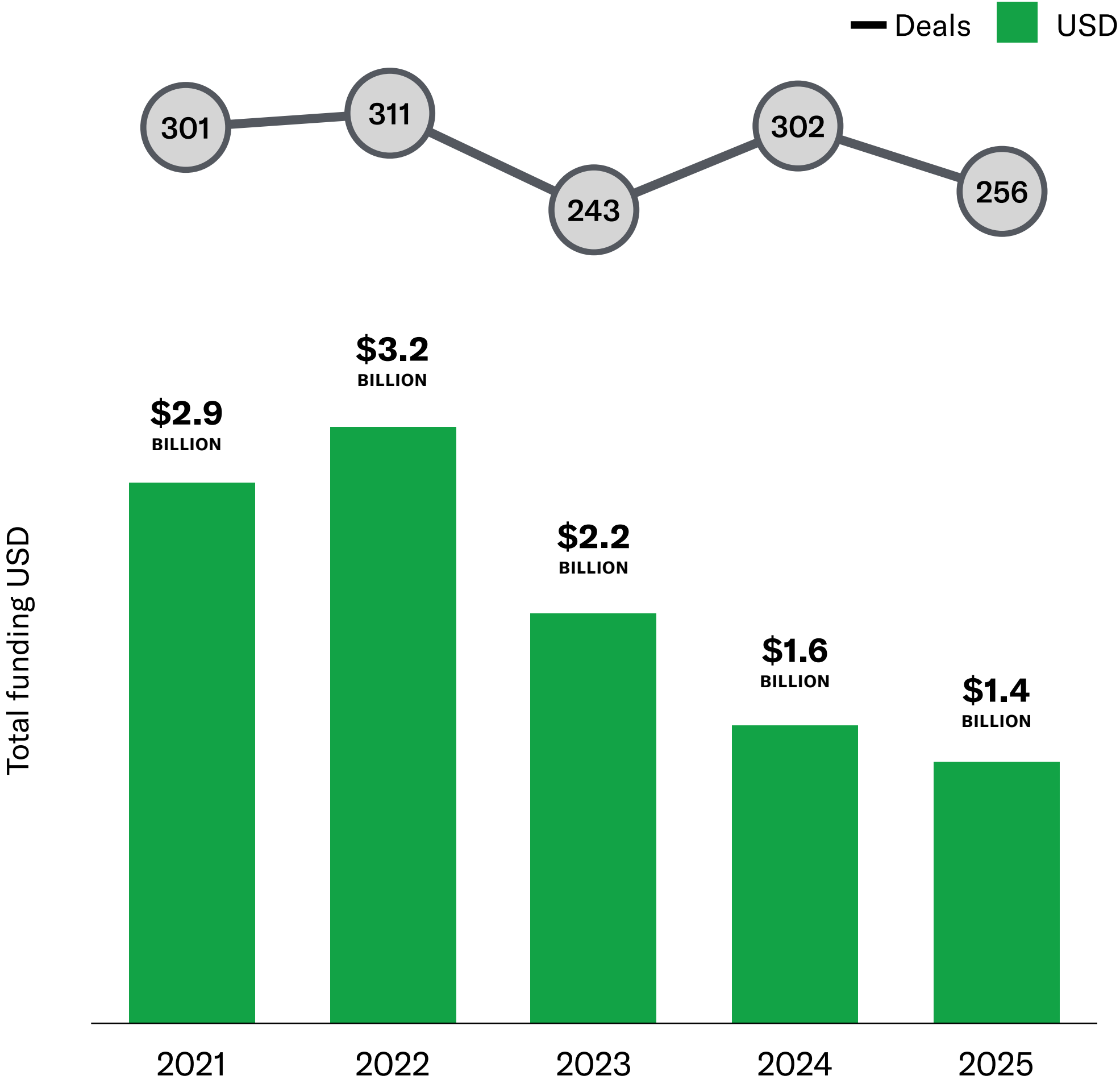


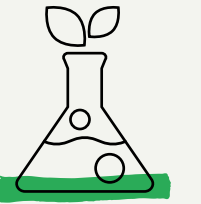
INARI CEO PONSI TRIVISVAVET

Top 5 deals in 2025

COMPANY	\$ TOTAL	COUNTRY	STAGE
Inari	144M	US	Late
Abiochem Biotechnology	62.9M	China	Late
Nitricity	62.6M	US	B
Wild Bioscience	60.4M	UK	A
Maikekang Biotechnology (also known as MaxVax)	55.7M	China	D

Total funding by year 2021–2025





Category spotlight - Ag Biotech



MATILDA HO, FOUNDER, ITS X BITES

Global funding to the ag biotech category has declined over the last few years, which is perhaps unsurprising given the long timelines and complex processes required to bring new crop protection chemistries, seed breeds, alternative forms of energy, and cleaner ingredients to market.

At the same time, the barriers to entry for ag biotech have come down in recent years thanks to advances in AI, robotics, and gene-editing technologies.

This, coupled with a rethink about how venture capital can become part of a more blended

financing model in biotech, could help shape the pace and ability of ag biotech companies to scale in the future.

One place already illustrating this is China.

Case study: China

In recent years, China has enacted a set of national priorities to boost self reliance in critical resources, including those for energy and agriculture. This has led to a state strategy driving infrastructure, policy, and capital, says Matilda Ho, founder and managing director of VC firm Bits x Bites.

"We are no longer looking at a 'me too' economy, but a specialized industrial machine reshaping energy, AI, and agrifood systems. The visible hand of state strategy and the invisible hand of the market have clasped together to build the next era of industrial growth."

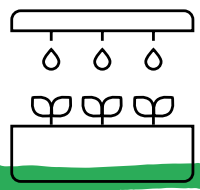
Practically, that shows up in policies like the country's five-year plan that aims to raise annual grain production via more drought- and disease-resistant crops developed through gene editing.

When it comes to scaling operations, Chinese biotech startups have a structural advantage, says Ho: "over 70% of global fermentation capacity, integrated supply chains, deep industrial scale-up know-how, and a rich talent pool."

Meanwhile, growth-stage companies contending with the current global funding crunch can leverage government-backed funds that provide more liquidity.

Through a fund-of-funds model, the state partners with professional general partners to channel capital toward strategic priorities, with a timeline that aligns with the development cycle of deep tech.

This structure, says Ho, offers "long duration capital to nurture breakthroughs, combining the stability of the state with the agility of private venture execution."



Category spotlight - Novel Farming Systems

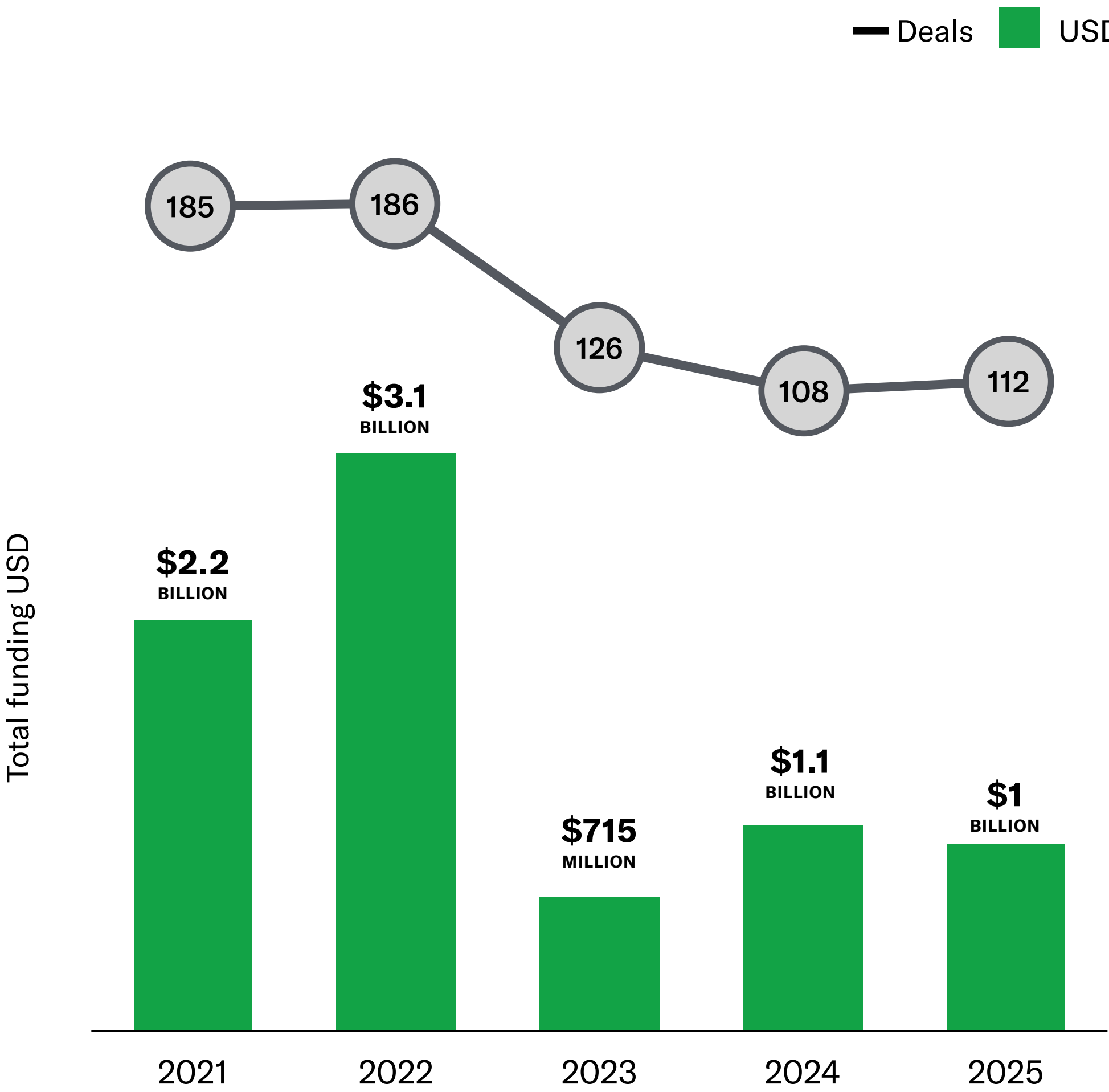


LAXEY COFOUNDERS

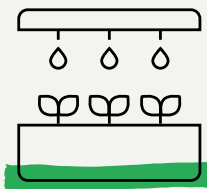
Top 5 deals in 2025

COMPANY	\$ TOTAL	COUNTRY	STAGE
80 Acres Farms	115M	US	Late
Soul of Japan Co.	110M	Japan	Debt
LAXEY	108M	Iceland	Debt
Stacked Farm	100M	Australia	Debt
Open Blue	99M	US	Late

Total funding by year 2021–2025



Category spotlight - Novel Farming Systems



MIKE ZELKIND, COFOUNDER AND CEO, 80 ACRES FARMS.

According to Agritecture's latest Global CEA Census, access to funding is now one of the top challenges for indoor ag startups. The 68% drop in VC funding between 2021 and 2025 illustrates this.

Bootstrapping is now the main funding model for almost half of all controlled-environment agriculture (CEA) operations, with grant funding is the second most-common source and "fewer farms reported receiving private capital."

While undoubtedly painful for startups, this seems the logical outcome for an industry that overpromised, grossly underdelivered, and sent generalist investors running for the hills in the aftermath.

Those private investors still funding the space now look for things like positive EBITDA, profitability benchmarks, energy efficiency of systems, and revenue per square meter per year.

As the CEA Census notes, "funding is no longer a function of vision; it's a function of metrics."

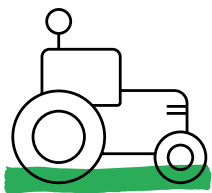
It's also important to remember that CEA is only one part of the novel farming systems category, and vertical farming's retreat from the headlines has given other startups—particularly those in the blue economy—greater visibility.

In 2025, blue economy startups such as seaweed farms, sustainable fisheries, and aquaculture systems figured much more prominently among the category's top rounds.

Blue economy deals have remained relatively stable since 2021, averaging between 40 and 45 per year. What looks like a rise in the data, then, is largely a normalization of the market after the vertical farming boom—not a sudden surge in marine startup formation.

This stability of blue economy funding is encouraging, particularly at a time when agrifoodtech VCs are readjusting expectations and moving away from the "growth-at-all-costs" narrative.

YEAR	BLUE ECONOMY FUNDING	VERTICAL FARM FUNDING
2021	291M	1.49BN
2022	470M	1.43BN
2023	130M	229M
2024	537M	309M
2025	470M	264M



Category spotlight - Farm Robotics, Mechanization & Other Equipment

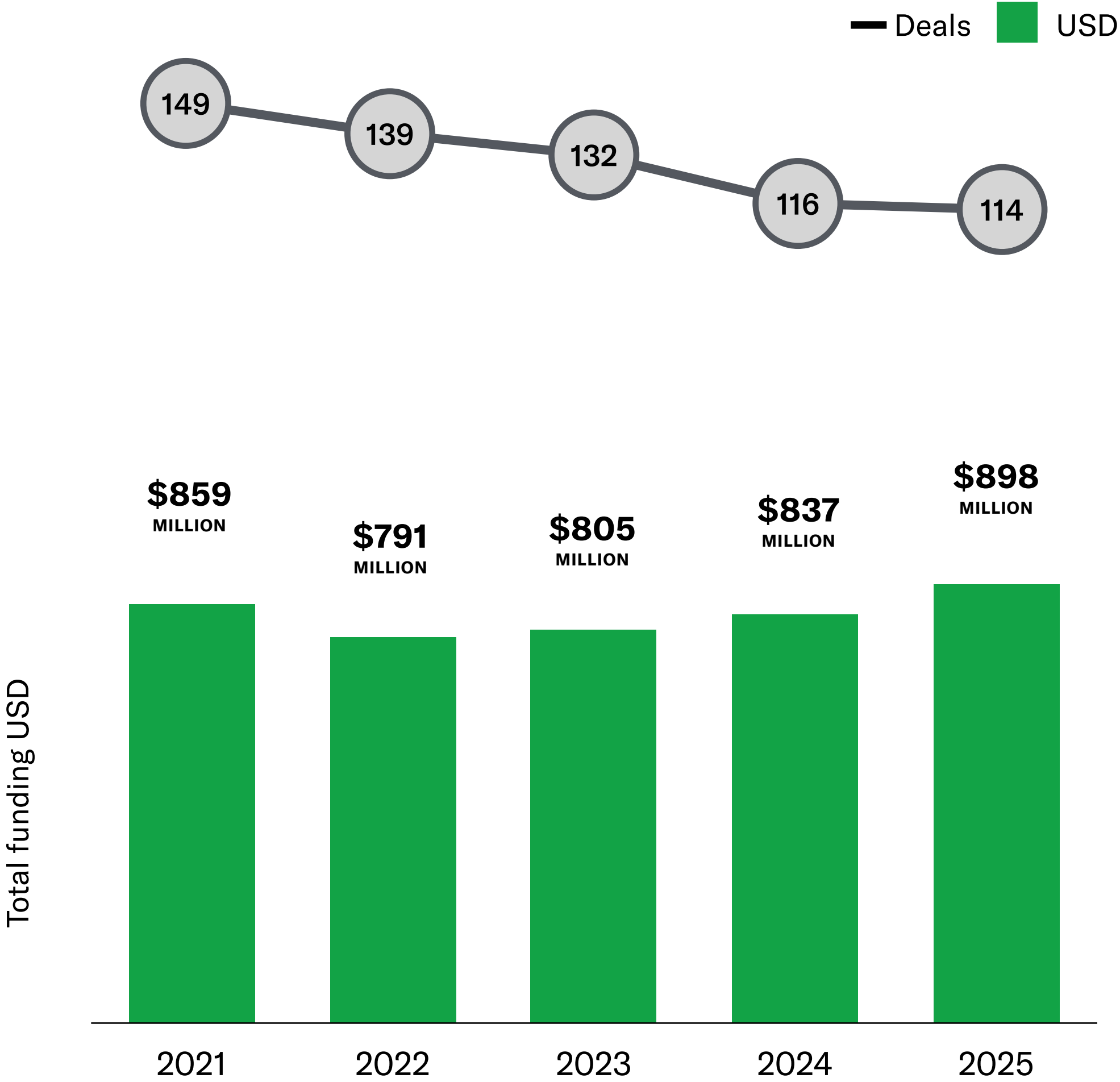


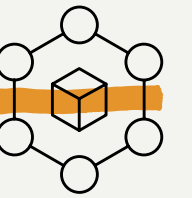
VERDANT ROBOTICS SHARPSHOOTER™

Top 5 deals in 2025

COMPANY	\$ TOTAL	COUNTRY	STAGE
Ecorobotix	105M	Switz	D
GINT	98M	S. Korea	C
Saildrone	60M	US	C
Beewise	50M	US	D
SwarmFarm	30M	Australia	B

Total funding by year 2021–2025





Category spotlight - Farm Robotics, Mechanization & Other Equipment



The biggest checks last year went to established players including Switzerland's Ecorobotix, which focuses on AI-guided precision crop treatment; South Korea's GINT, which develops systems that turn tractors and other farm equipment into self-driving machines; and Israel's Beewise, which uses cameras, sensors, and a robotic arm to analyze hive conditions and intervene automatically or alert beekeepers remotely.

In the notoriously challenging robotic harvesting space for more delicate crops, Canadian ag robotics startup 4AG Robotics secured a sizable B round to accelerate adoption of its autonomous mushroom harvesting tech beyond Canada, Ireland, and Australia into the Netherlands and

the US, while a small check went to TerraForce for its melon-picking machines.

Bonsai Robotics—which raised a \$15 million Series A round in February 2025—went on to acquire farm-ng, bringing together expertise in software and hardware, says cofounder Tyler Niday.

“To date, our vision has been to make autonomy and AI accessible, easy to use, and deployable across all farm equipment.” With farm-ng, he says, Bonsai hopes to “unlock this bigger vision to have new form factors on the farm. You can do more if you’re not designing around a human.”

Other notable rounds went to two players applying UVC light via autonomous ‘bots to target fungal pathogens: Saga Robotics, which is focused on tabletop strawberries in the UK and vineyards in California; and TRIC Robotics, which is focused on strawberries grown in open fields.

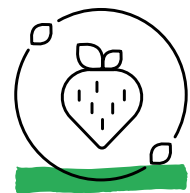
While much of the tech in this category helps growers apply crop inputs more precisely, AgZen—which raised a \$10 million Series A in March 2025 and a \$10 million Series B in March 2026—takes this a step further with a “feedback-optimized” smart spraying system that enables farmers to cut chemical inputs by 30–50% without reducing yields.

Its camera-stacked unit can be bolted onto any sprayer and linked to a tablet in the cab, allowing operators to see what is happening to droplets in real time. The AI-powered system can then recommend how to optimize everything from nozzle selection, pressure, boom height, and droplet size to driving speed and gallons of spray per acre for a given chemical mix, crop, and location.

“We’ve been spraying at scale for 80+ years, but no one has been able to measure how many droplets of chemicals are actually getting onto the weeds or crops, which makes it difficult to judge both the efficacy of the chemicals and the efficiency of application,” says CEO Vishnu Jayaprakash. “We’re taking off the blindfold.”

>>**What to watch:** While few dollars went into the ag spray drone space in 2025, that could change in 2026 as rules banning new “foreign-made” models and critical components in the US spur a surge of investment into the domestic industry.

Elsewhere, new players are emerging using drones for livestock management, pollination, and yield forecasting.



Category spotlight - Innovative Food

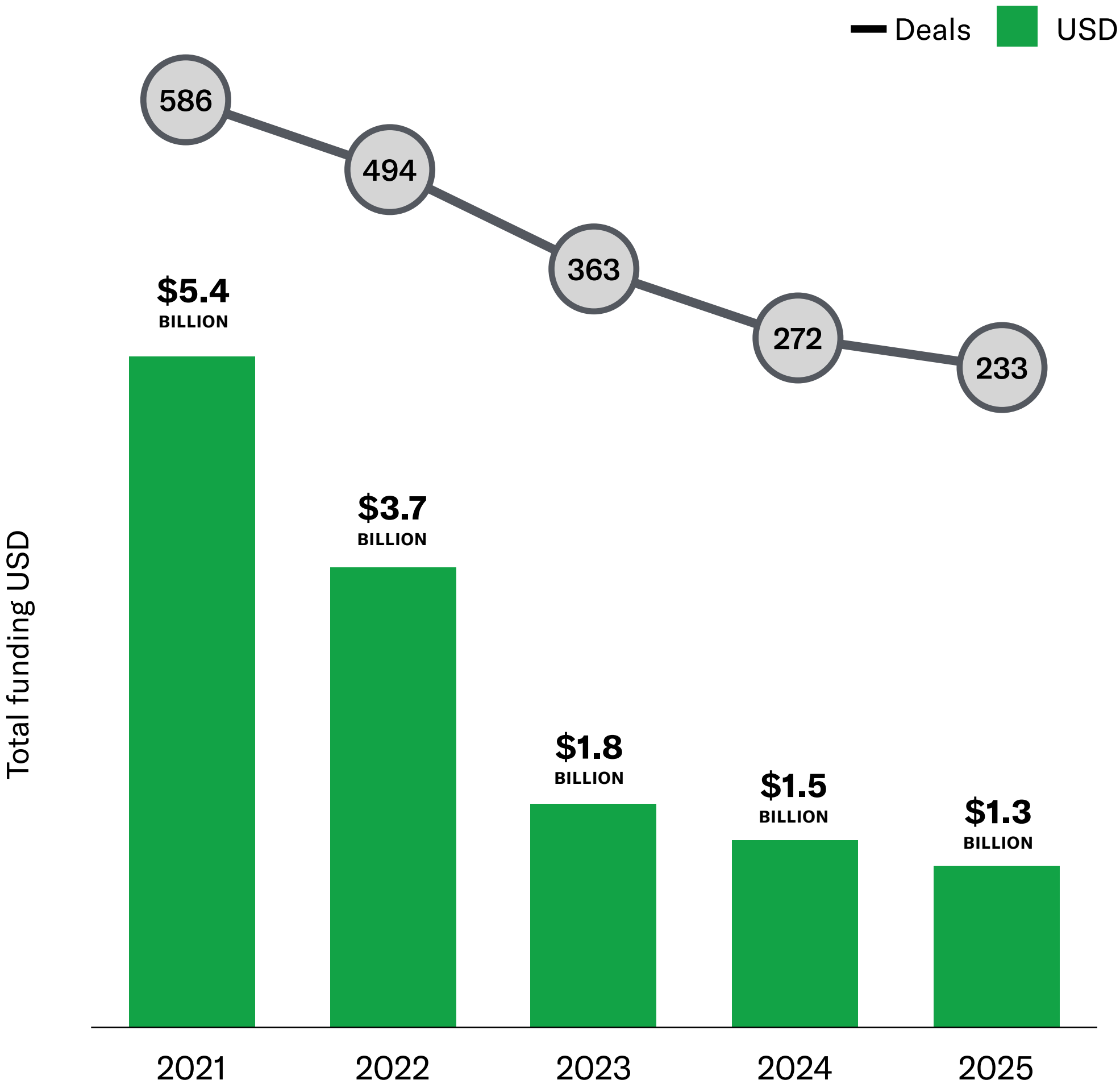


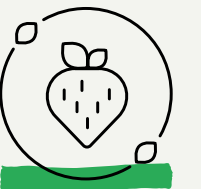
ARTURO ELIZONDO, CEO, THE EVERY COMPANY

Top 5 deals in 2025

COMPANY	\$ TOTAL	COUNTRY	STAGE
Intact	77M	France	Debt
David Protein	75M	US	A
Blueprint	60M	US	Seed
Nxtfood	58M	France	Late
The EVERY Company	55M	US	D

Total funding by year 2021–2025





Category spotlight - Innovative Food



CHRISTIE LAGALLY BRADBURN, CEO, REBELLYOUS FOODS

In a [recent analysis](#), Eugen Kaprov at The New Bioeconomy shared “the most comprehensive database of every agrifood-climate tech company that failed, collapsed, or entered severe distress between 2023 and early 2026.”

Unsurprisingly, alternative protein—which accounts for the bulk of funding in our innovative food category—gets star billing.

But remarkably few of these companies “failed because the science didn’t work or the product was too bad,” Kaprov asserts. “The failures sort into financing mismatches, broken unit economics, infrastructure shocks, and markets that evaporated. These are financing failures dressed up as technology failures.”

As Kaprov observes, some technologies being funded needed 12–15 years to reach commercial viability but got funded anyway. “The implicit bet: someone else will buy the company before the math catches up.” Others in turn “built supply for demand that existed in pitch decks.”

Still more raised funds on the premise that their margins would make sense at large scale. But scale didn’t fix the math, says Kaprov, citing the [spectacular fall of Meati](#), which produced fungi-based steaks via a costly submerged fermentation process and built a facility its new owner acknowledged was unprofitable and unsustainable. “It magnified the losses.”

For alt-meat companies that have raised far more modest sums and got the unit economics right from the start, however, things look sunnier, says Christie Lagally Bradburn at [Rebellyous Foods](#).

Rebellyous, which makes plant-based nuggets, notched up 30% growth in 2025 with foodservice customers now “choosing our products over chicken” because they are cheaper. [JOYN Foods](#)—a startup with a lower-cost “50Cut” blended meat solution enabling foodservice clients to save money and improve nutrition—also expects to triple revenues this year and become EBITDA-positive in early 2027.

Other players in the category, such as [Lasso](#), meanwhile, have repurposed their tech beyond alt meat into snacks and secured fresh funding, while biomass fermentation co The Protein Brewery is tapping into the protein craze spanning multiple categories rather than pinning its hopes on meat.

Indeed, protein is hotter than ever in the US market following the release of dietary guidelines recommending a near-doubling of intakes and the growing penetration of GLP-1 drugs, with startups now offering solutions from enzymes that increase protein absorption (Amplifye) to “insanely soluble” proteins (Alpine Bio) enabling formulators to pack ever greater amounts into snacks and beverages.

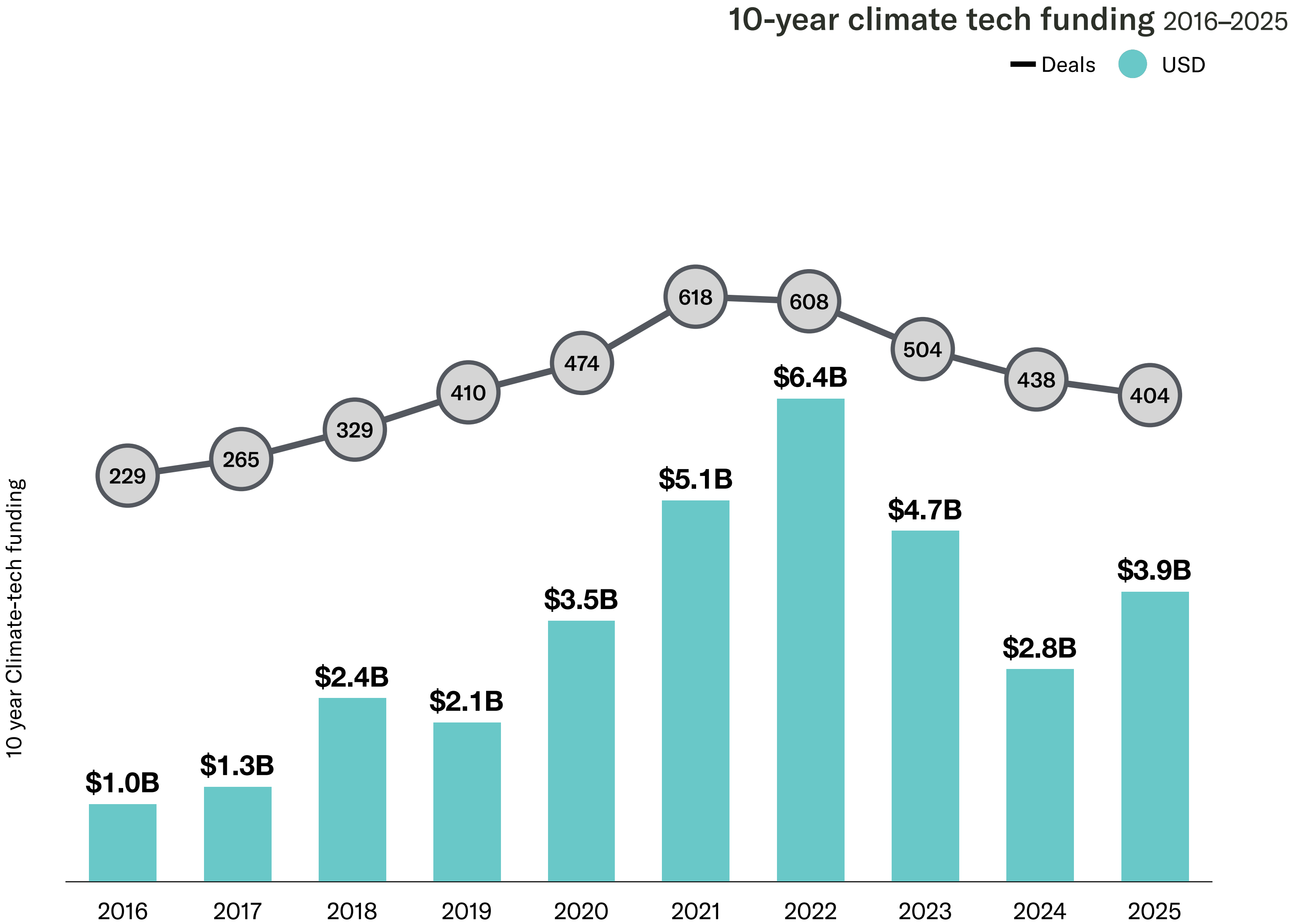
In precision fermentation, [advances in AI/ML](#) to optimize cell lines and bioprocesses, novel approaches to [tackle declining cell productivity](#), [continuous processing](#), novel bioreactor designs, and [cell-free biomanufacturing](#) may, over time, help these firms compete with petrochemicals.

In the meantime, startups in this space are pivoting to higher-margin products (lactoferrin over casein) or verticals (biopharma and nutraceuticals over food) or adding value by functionalizing their proteins ([Verley](#)) or using them as carriers for minerals ([Eden Brew](#)).

10 year climate tech funding in agrifoodtech

Just as we parsed out the deeptech companies within agrifood, we did the same for those providing climate solutions to understand if this subsegment is behaving differently to agrifoodtech more broadly. (See p. 63 for more detail on the methodology.)

Climate tech is experiencing a funding recovery, though the bulk of it is anchored by large deals for carbon measurement company Chestnut Carbon, bioenergy group Cambrian Innovation, chitosan solutions developer Tidal Vision, waste-to-energy management company Gestcompost, and biomethane producer CH4T. All raised \$100 million or greater rounds in 2025.



The climate tech premium

When does it appear?

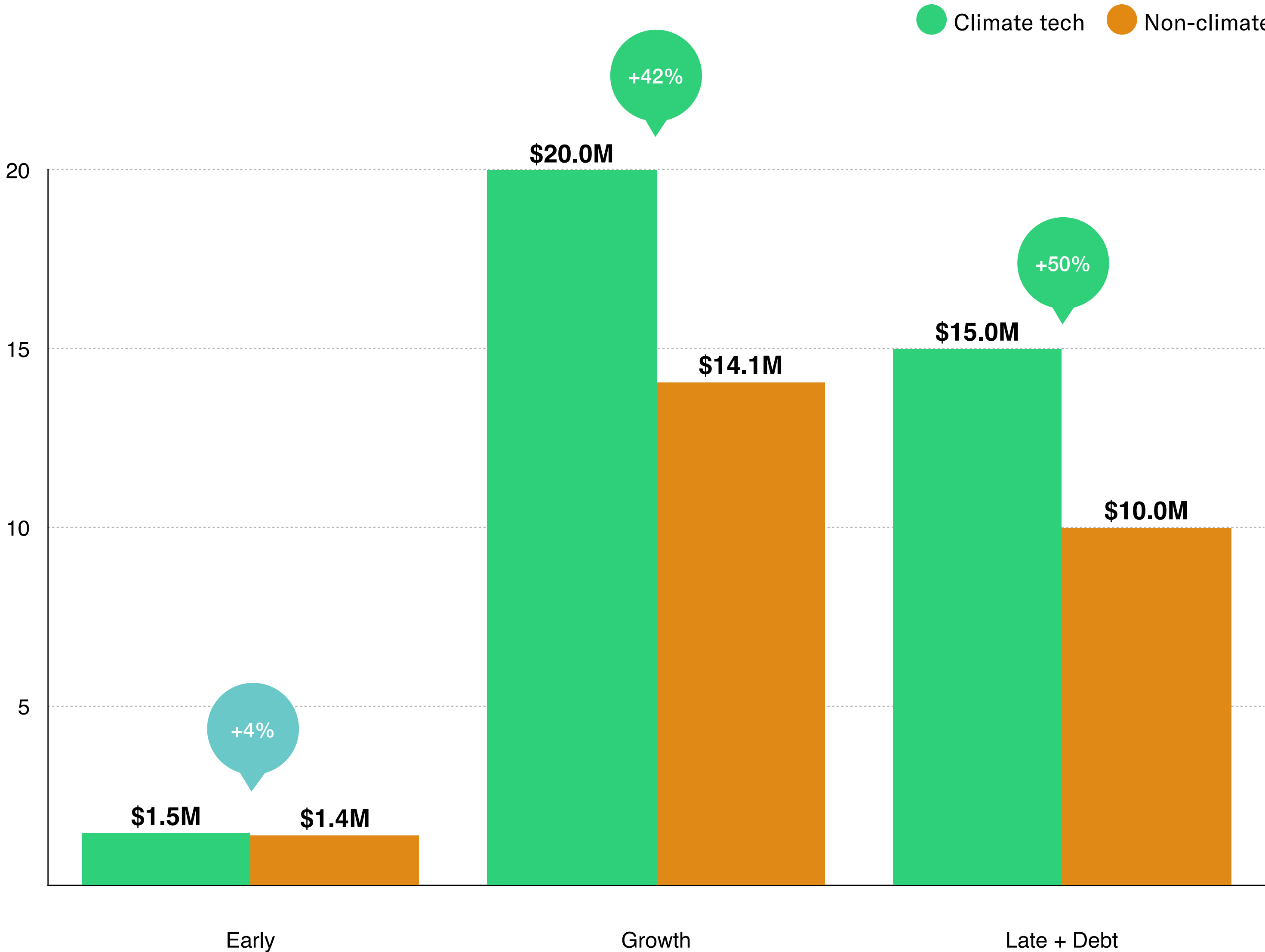
The bubbles on the chart represent median deal sizes for climate tech startups in our dataset compared to non-climate tech startups in 2025.

Startups solving for climate issues closed larger deals, both by average (\$13.1 million versus \$10.6 million) and by median, as shown.

Climate capital in 2025 was especially concentrated in structured financing and a narrower band of larger follow-on rounds, rather than being broadly larger at every venture stage.

Early-stage climate tech is still priced as a risk-heavy venture category, while C, D, and Debt are where climate companies finally start to look financeable, contract-backed, and deployment-ready to a broader capital base.

Agrifoodtech median deal sizes 2025



Startup Profile - Azaneo



AZANEO COFOUNDER LIAM HESCOCK

Reducing herbicide use is a big mission of ours, but we strongly believe you have to have the unit economics to also drive adoption. If we get this right, we can smack herbicide in terms of price.



LIAM HESCOCK

azaneo.au »

Australia's Azaneo puts a new twist on electro-weeding by leveraging a method more commonly found in medical settings than vegetable fields.

What challenge does Azaneo solve?

Reducing herbicide use is a big mission of ours, but we strongly believe you have to have the unit economics to also drive adoption. The productivity and the economics have to be there, and if we get this right, we can smack herbicide in terms of price.

Azaneo is leading the application of the well-established technique of electroporation for use in agriculture. Electroporation is a proven method used in medicine and food processing to destroy cells—but it has never been applied to weed control in the field.

By delivering a precisely controlled high-voltage pulse, microscopic pores form in plant cell membranes and cellular function is disrupted, leading to rapid and irreversible cell death.

No chemicals, heat, or mechanical damage are involved.

This is different than just killing a plant with temperature. There are a number of companies that have done that and it works, but it will use a lot more energy and you'll have to go slower because of it.

What were Azaneo's highlights in 2025?

We were awarded \$250,000 from the Australian government's Industry Growth Program to build a pilot of our Pulsed Electric Field weed control technology.

The big thing in the last year is we went from less than a kilometer an hour weeding to four to six kilometers, and that's been huge in terms of getting us ready for commercial launch. We're aiming to be a similar speed to herbicide in terms of this application.

Plans for 2026?

We're building our first system, designed to work on vegetable farms in Australia.

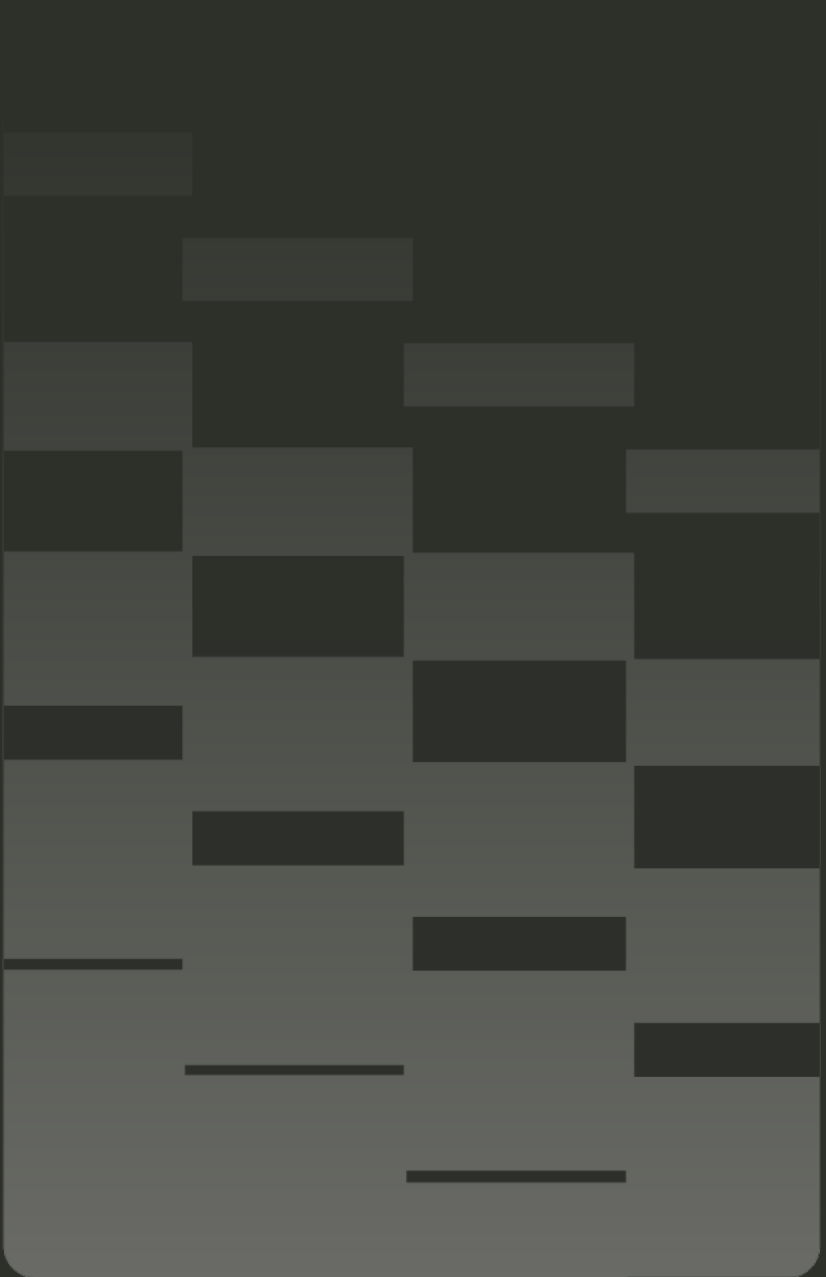
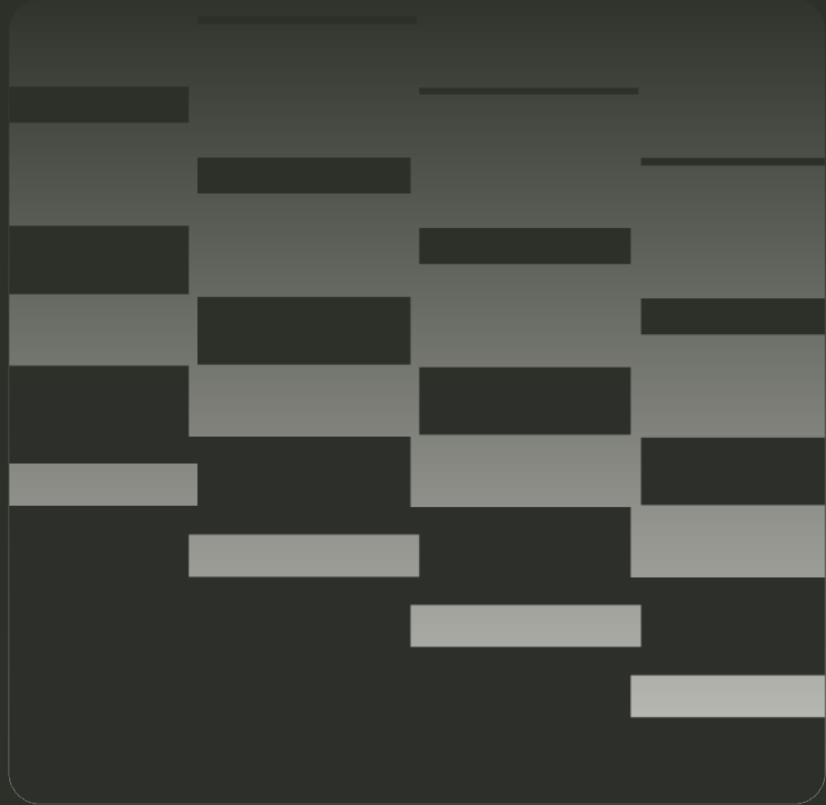
In the next two to three months, we'll be testing this, making sure it works on our farm, and then we'll be testing it on a bunch of different farms in Australia before going from the trial phase to hopefully filling out an order book to build five to 10 of these later this year and turning those field trials into sales.

We're actively looking for trial partners and supporters in Australia, the US, and Europe.

[Disclosure: AgFunder is an investor in Azaneo.]

AgFunder

Analysis by Geography



LEE CHAE BRIGHTSEED

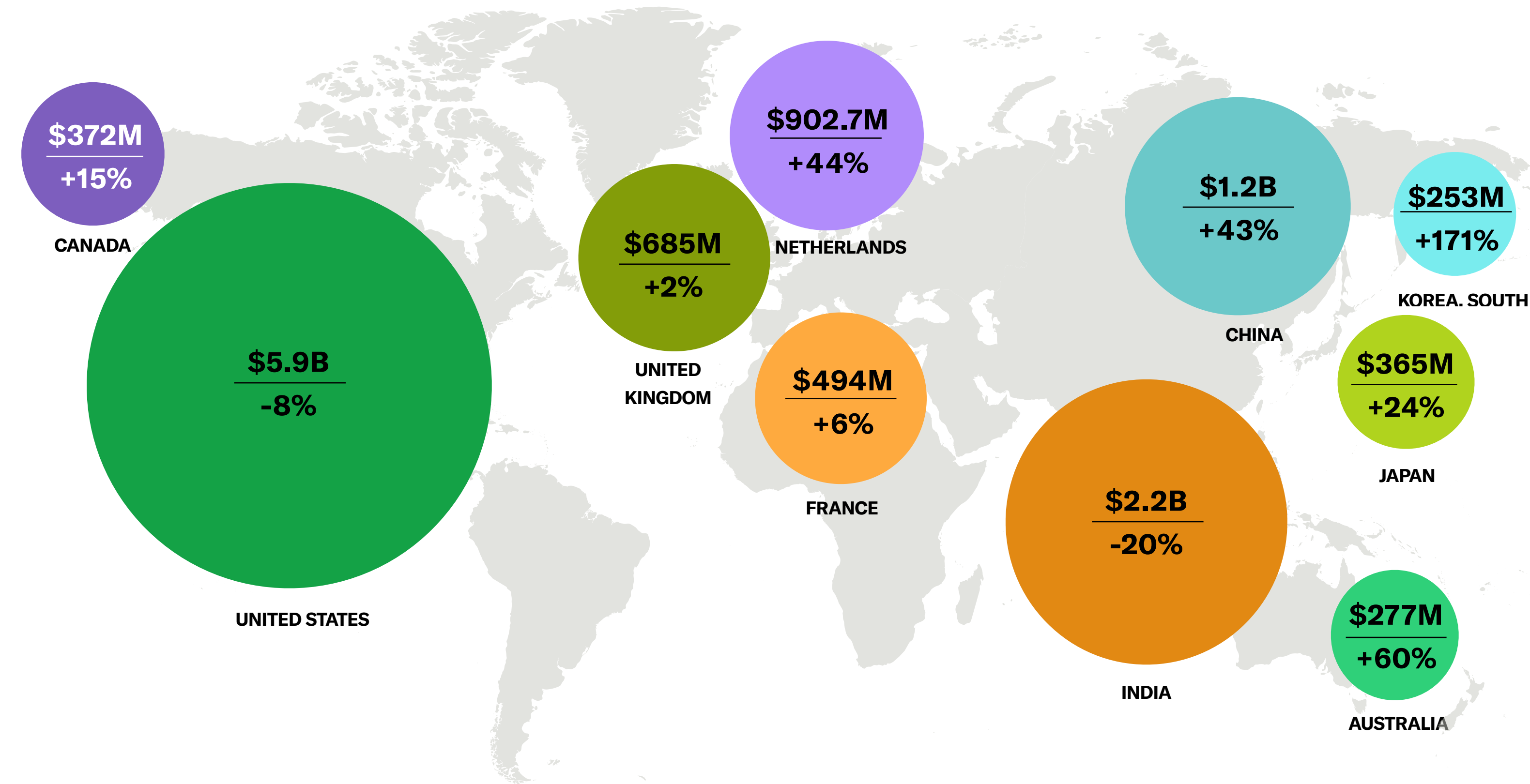


2025 agrifoodtech funding by country

The list of top-funded countries in 2025 is almost identical to 2024. However, while the US still leads global funding, YoY investment totals and deal counts were down in 2025.

China, meanwhile, saw a 16% growth in deal count in addition to an uptick for investment totals. The country's most recent five-year plan includes high ambitions around food security; strong investment totals in Ag Biotech and Midstream Technologies reflects this.

Global agrifoodtech investment by country



COUNTRY	\$ TOTAL	\$ CHANGE	DEALS	COUNTRY	\$ TOTAL	\$ CHANGE	DEALS
United States	5.9B	-8%	507	France	494M	6%	63
India	2.2B	-20%	188	Canada	372M	15%	74
China	1.2B	43%	199	Japan	365M	24%	59
Netherlands	902M	44%	50	Australia	277M	60%	30
United Kingdom	685M	2%	111	Korea, South	253M	171%	49

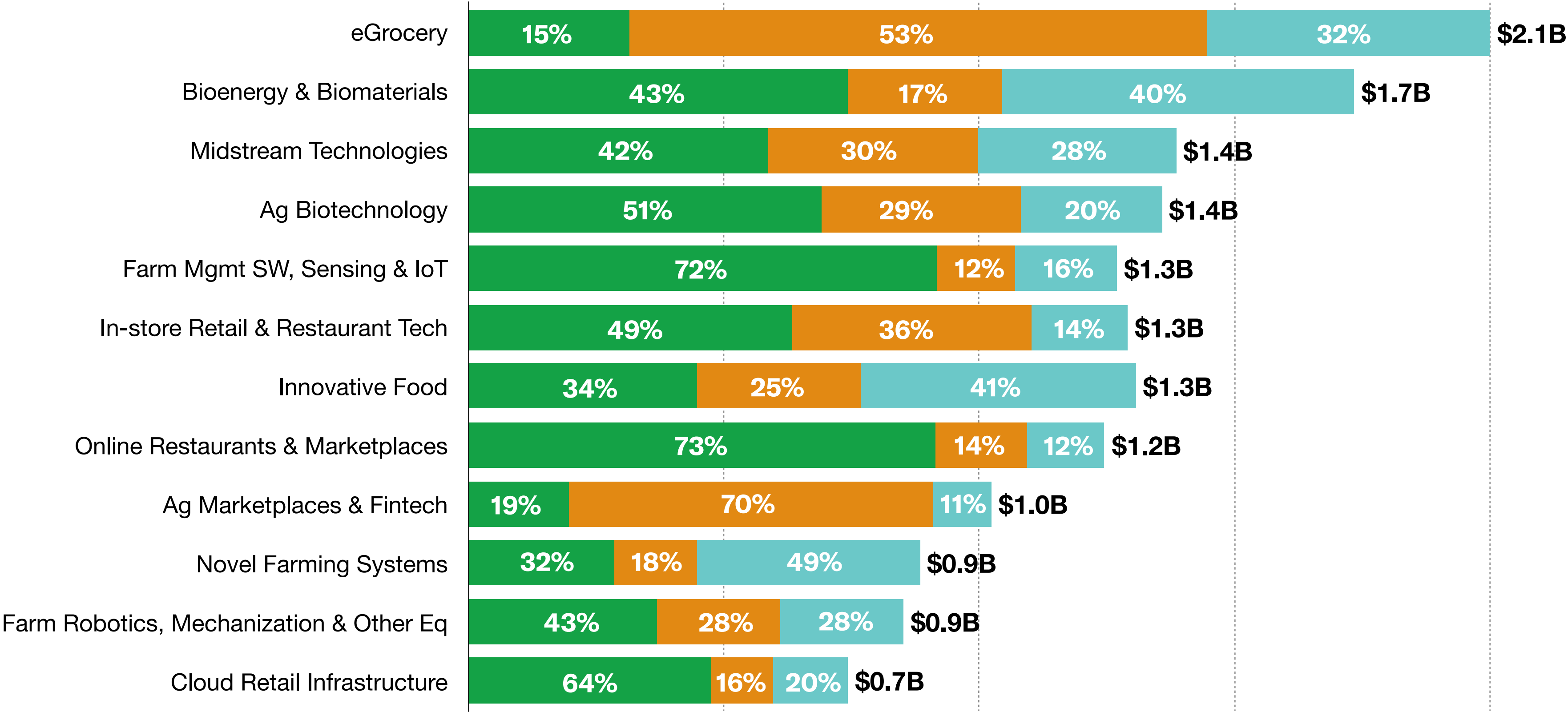
Regional investment by category

Despite an 8% decline in total funding, the US is still the dominant market. It leads investment in Ag Biotech, where its startups took 57% of developed market funding, buoyed by some large gene editing raises. It also contributed some \$1.1 billion of funding to robotics, automation and management software tools in the Retail and Restaurant Tech category.

Europe accounted for 60% of Novel Farming Systems’ developed market funding, with a large Finnish aquaculture deal accounting for nearly half of that.

Regional funding by category 2025

Americas Asia Europe



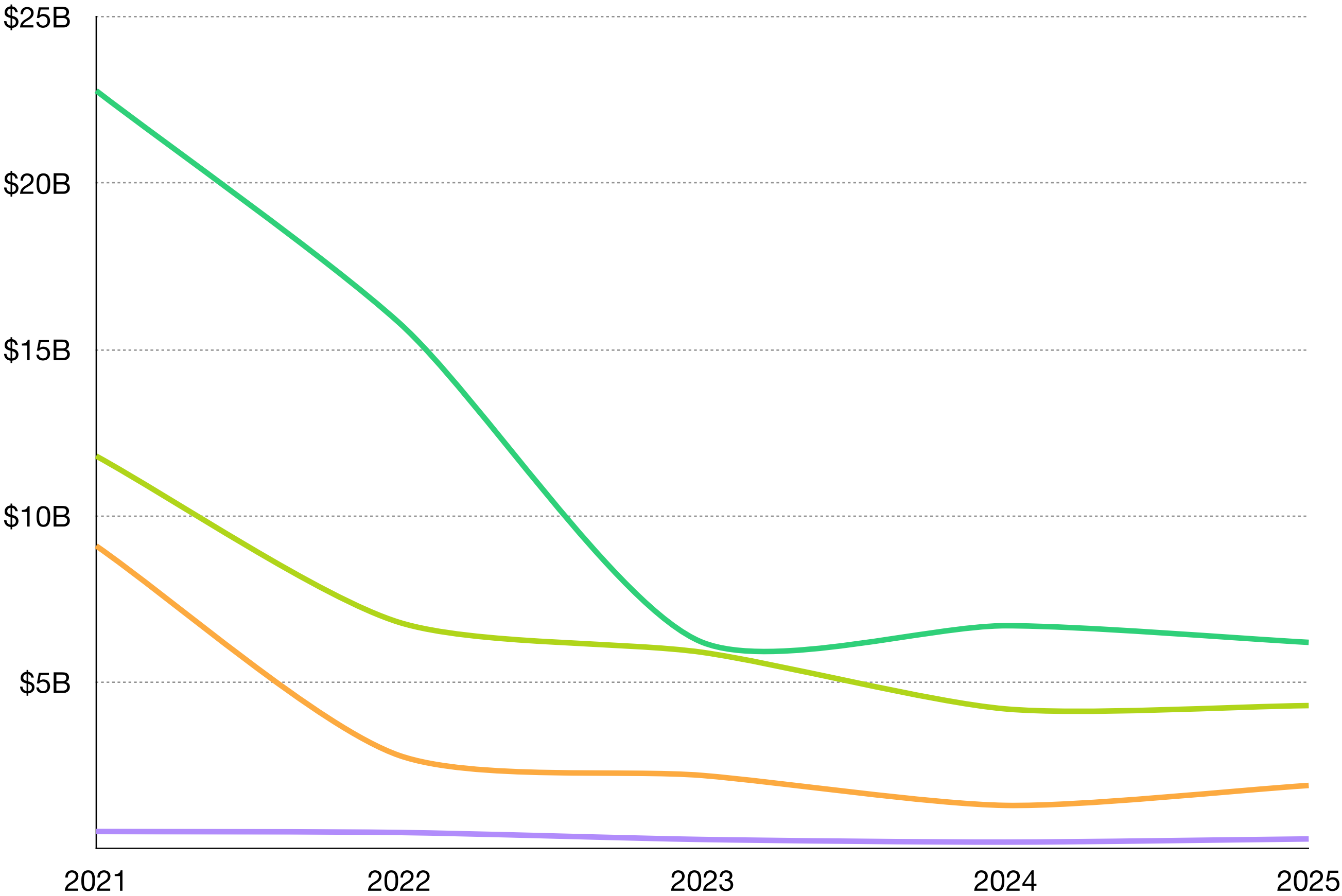
Developed markets: investment by region

Top 10 developed markets 2025

COUNTRY	\$ TOTAL	\$ YOY	DEALS
United States	5.9B	-8%	507
China	1.2B	43%	199
Netherlands	902.7M	44%	50
United Kingdom	685.4M	2%	111
France	494.5M	6%	63
Canada	372.2M	15%	74
Japan	365.3M	24%	59
Australia	277.5M	60%	30
Korea, South	253.3M	171%	49
Iceland	250.1M	87%	6

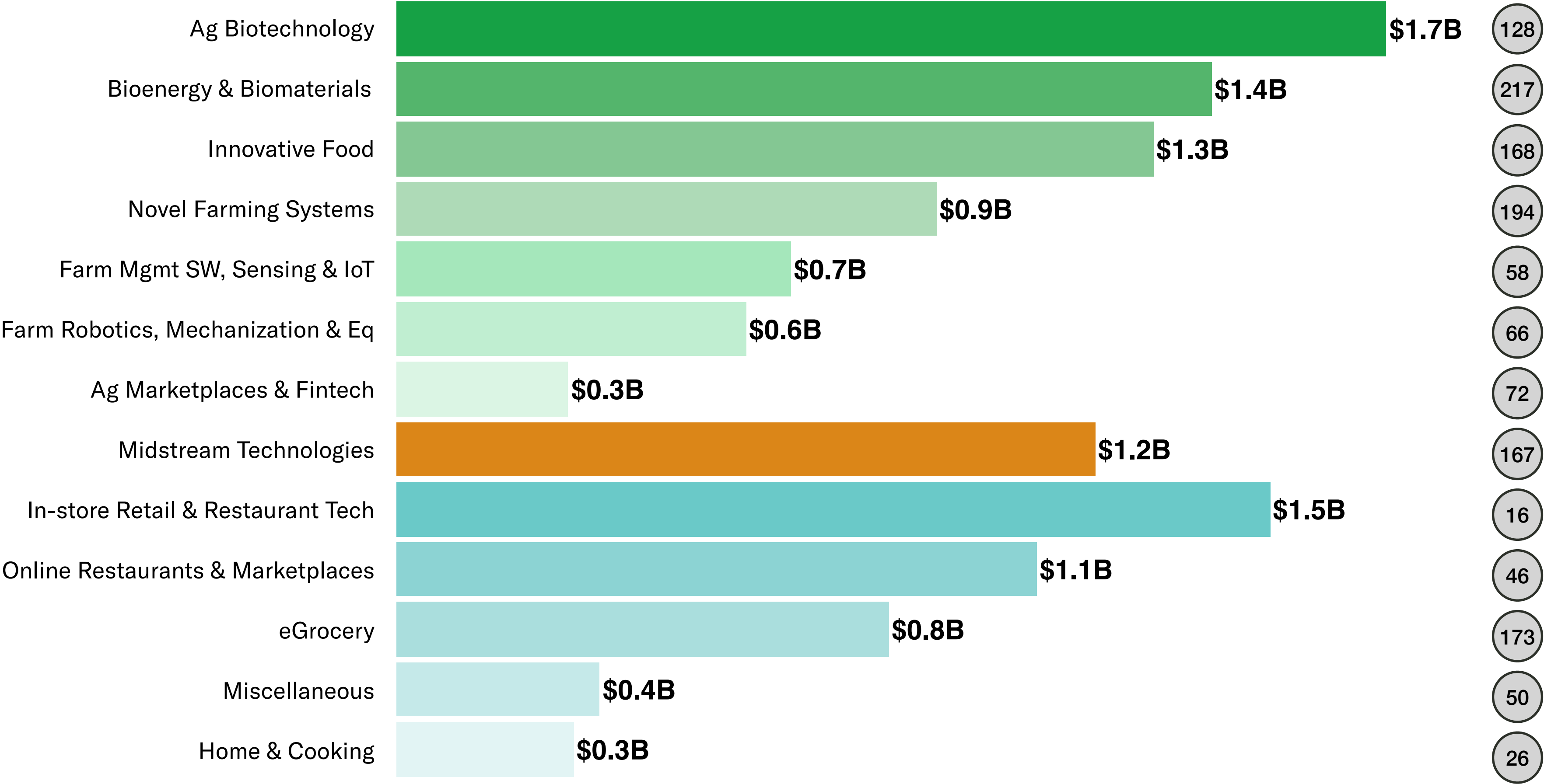
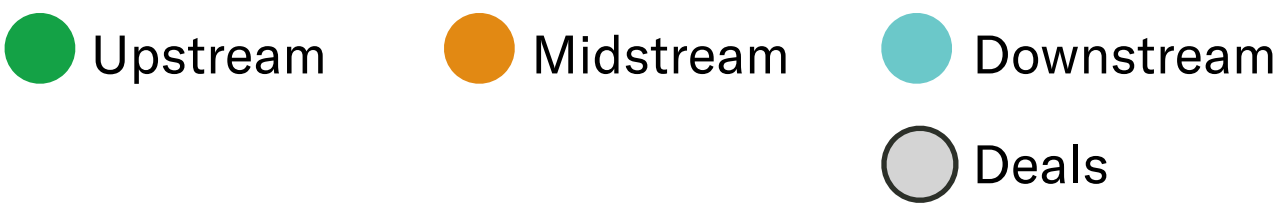
Funding by developed region 2021–2025

Americas Eastern Asia Europe + Israel Oceania



Developed markets: investment by category

Developed markets funding by category 2025



Comparing agrifoodtech in developed markets to those in the Global South reveals, somewhat unsurprisingly, more funding to upstream and deeptech startups from biotech to robotics and AI.

Developed markets:

top 10 deals 2025

Top-funded developed markets agrifoodtech companies 2025

A greater percentage of top deals in Developed Markets went to upstream companies in 2025 than 2024: 60% versus 30%, respectively.

This appears to be the norm rather than the exception over the last half-decade, however: some 80% of top deals were upstream in both 2022 and 2023.

	COMPANY	TOTAL \$	COUNTRY	CATEGORY	STAGE
1		600.0M	United States	Online Restaurants & Marketplaces	D
2		495.4M	Netherlands	eGrocer	Late
3		250.0M	United States	Online Restaurants & Marketplaces	Debt
4		250.0M	United States	eGrocer	Late
5		210.0M	United States	Farm Mgmt SW, Sensing & IoT	Debt
6		160.0M	United States	Farm Mgmt SW, Sensing & IoT	B
7		150.0M	United States	Bioenergy & Biomaterials	Debt
8		144.0M	United States	Ag Biotechnology	Late
9		140.0M	United States	Bioenergy & Biomaterials	B
10		130.9M	Spain	Bioenergy & Biomaterials	Late

Startup profile - Klim



KLIM TEAM

Through extensive conversations with agri-food customers, CFO teams, and financial institutions, we identified a clear gap: decision-makers needed a credible way to quantify how regenerative transitions affect P&L, risk, and enterprise value.



ROBERT GERLACH, CEO, KLIM

klim.eco »

Klim accelerates the global transition to regenerative agriculture by providing a seamless, scalable solution for food companies to transform their agricultural supply chains. Its digital platform empowers farmers with tools to plan, implement, and finance regenerative practices, tackling key barriers such as limited agronomist support and transition capital.

What challenge does Klim solve?

Klim provides the digital infrastructure to regenerate soils at scale and speed, thereby ensuring the economic viability of the agri-food system. We enable food companies (e.g., Nestlé, ADM, Aldi), financial institutions (e.g., Rabobank, BNP), and farmers to stabilize supply, reduce volatility, and improve long-term resilience, while delivering certified climate and biodiversity outcomes.

At the core is Klim’s supply-chain offering and farmer platform, including a digital regenerative agronomist that allows farmers and supply-chain partners to assess soil health, model transition pathways, and implement regenerative practices based on profitability and risk outcomes. In addition, Klim connects farmers and food

companies to favorable transition finance through partnerships with leading banks and insurers.

What were Klim's highlights in 2025?

2025 was a transformative year for Klim. We significantly strengthened our digital regenerative agronomist, enabling more cost-effective and scalable supply-chain conversion. We launched our agri-food P&L and enterprise valuation model, as well as loan offerings for farmers and agri-food companies in partnership with leading banks. We entered new markets, including the UK, strengthened the Klim management team, and further expanded our leadership position in regenerative supply-chain conversion.

A symbolic highlight was seeing Klim featured at Times Square in New York as one of the leading global impact companies, reflecting the growing international relevance of our work.

Plans for 2026?

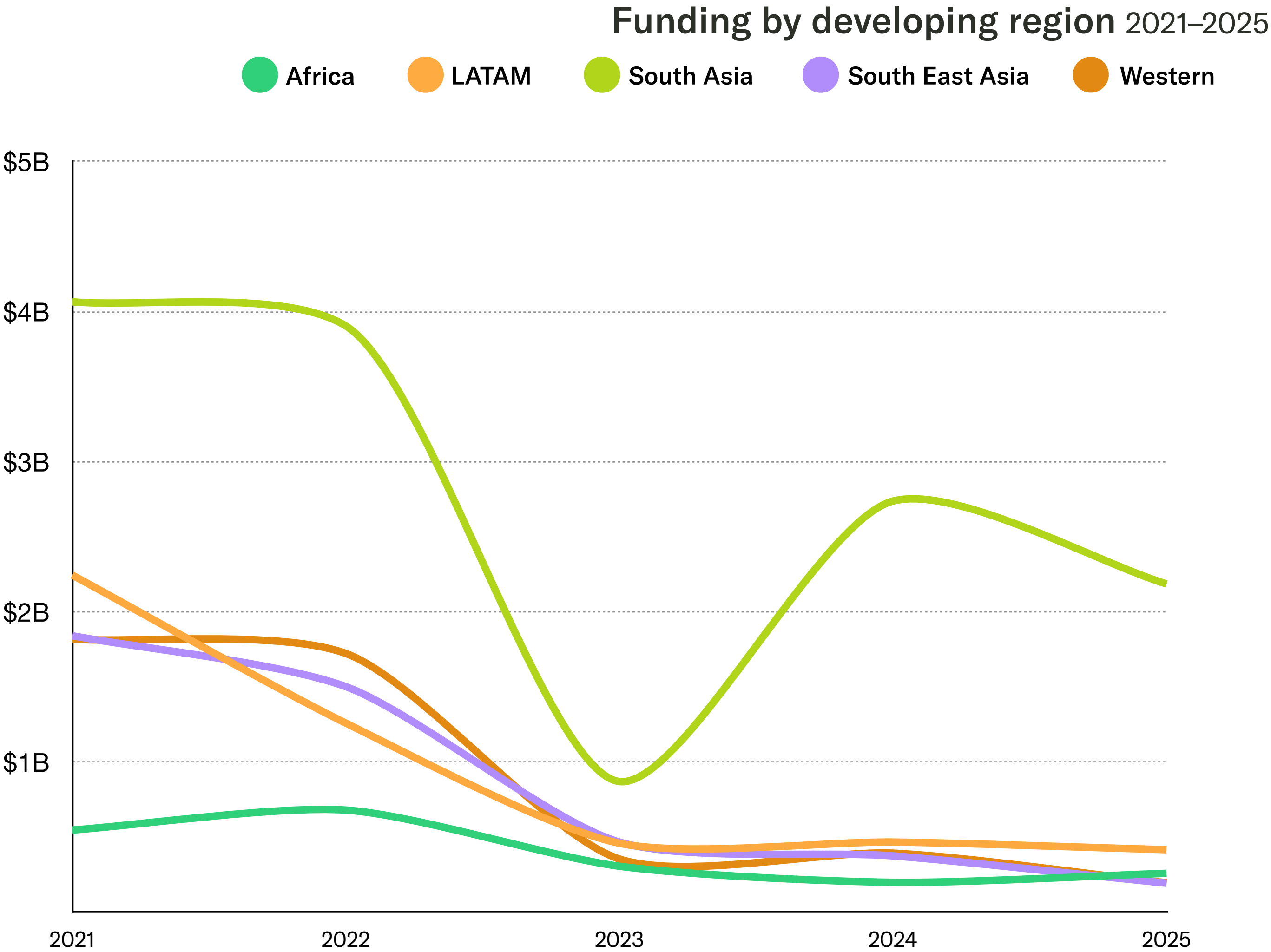
In 2026, Klim will continue to deepen its farmer value proposition and accelerate the rollout of its financial value layer. You will see new partnerships across the agri-food and finance sectors, broader deployment of our P&L and risk modeling capabilities, and faster scaling of regenerative supply-chain programs.

[Disclosure: AgFunder is an investor in Klim.]

Developing markets: investment by region

Top 10 developing markets 2025

COUNTRY	\$ TOTAL	\$ YOY	DEALS
India	2.2B	-20%	188
Brazil	227.5M	-14%	38
Colombia	126.4M	962%	8
Saudi Arabia	100.1M	122%	13
Kenya	96.2M	1%	18
Indonesia	85.8M	-50%	10
Singapore	75.5M	-56%	16
Bahrain	40.3M	61%	3
Chile	38.5M	-36%	10
Egypt	36.5M	42%	11



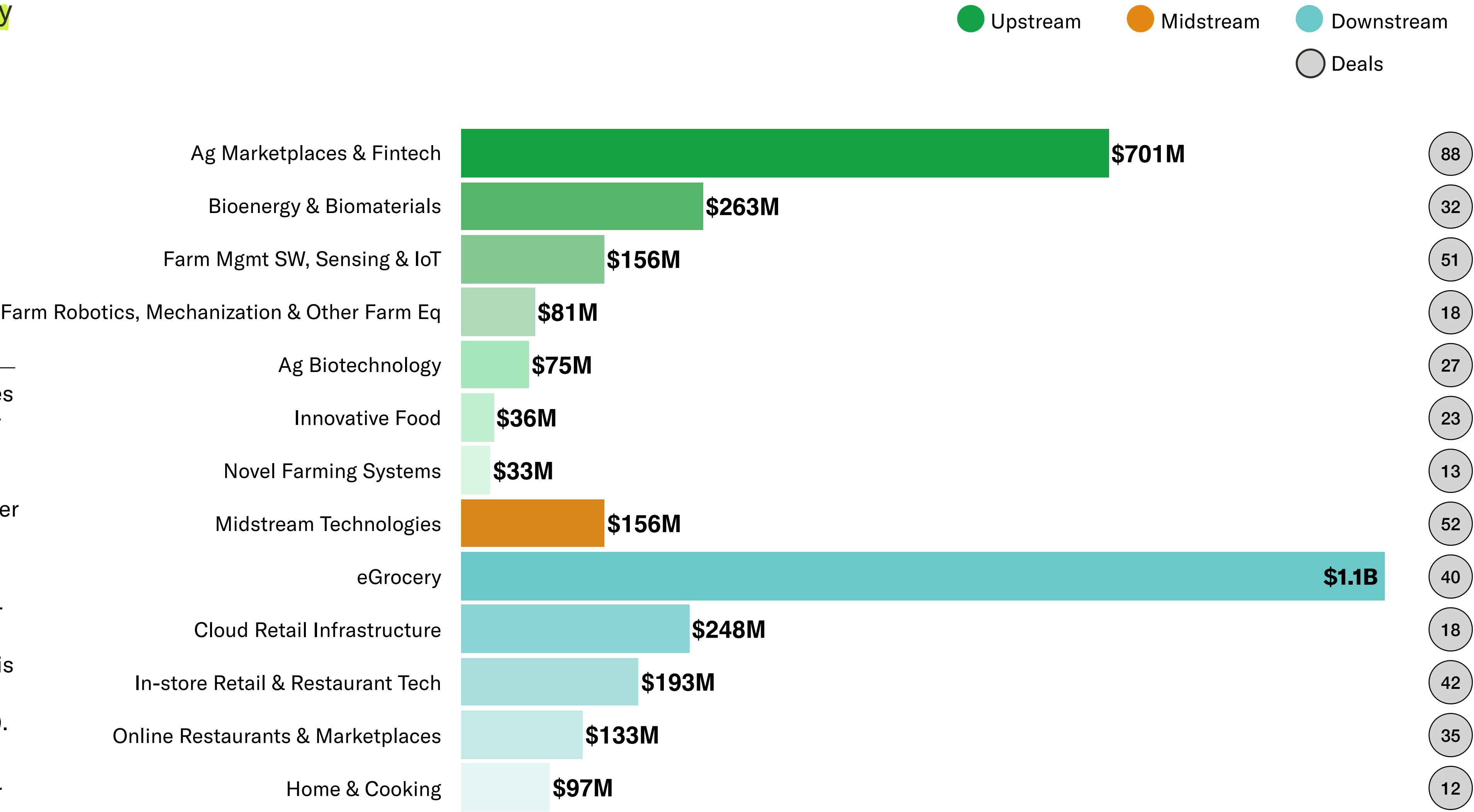
Developing markets: investment by category

Capital distribution across categories remains similar to previous years for developing markets, with eGrocery continuing to dominate as the near-monopoly companies raise ever-larger rounds ahead of inevitable IPOs.

However, deal size for food delivery companies—particularly eGrocery—has shrunk over time. The highest raise in 2025 (Zepto's \$450 million) is nearly 45% lower than the highest raise in 2021 (Swiggy's \$800 million).

For more insights on developing markets agrifoodtech, stay tuned for our upcoming report.

Developing markets funding by category 2025



Developing markets:

top 10 deals 2025

Top-funded developing markets agrifoodtech companies 2025

Despite overall compression of the largest deals, total investment for the top 10 rounds in 2025 was slightly higher than in 2024, at \$1.4 billion versus \$1.3 billion.

For the second year in a row, Zepto and Samunnati led downstream and upstream funding, respectively.

	COMPANY	TOTAL \$	COUNTRY	CATEGORY	STAGE
1	 zepto	450.0M	India	eGrocer	Late
2	 Samunnati	267.4M	India	Ag Marketplaces & Fintech	Debt
3	 blinkit	173.1M	India	eGrocer	Late
4	 Jumbotail	120.0M	India	Ag Marketplaces & Fintech	D
5	 Rappi	100.0M	Colombia	Cloud Retail Infrastructure	Debt
6	 IOC GPS Renewables Pvt. Ltd.	94.2M	India	Bioenergy & Biomaterials	Debt
7	 burn™ life · saving · stoves	80.0M	Kenya	Home & Cooking	Debt
8	 KPN fresh	72.3M	India	eGrocer	Late
9	 blinkit	67.3M	India	eGrocer	Late
10	 Tobasa BIOINDUSTRIAL uma companhia ecológica	64.8M	Brazil	Bioenergy & Biomaterials	Debt

Startup profile - SEADLING



SEADLING TEAM

Borneo-based biotech startup SEADLING develops functional, seaweed-based products for animal, human, and plant health while collaborating with local farming communities to improve environments and livelihoods.

What global challenges does SEADLING hope to solve?

We bypass exploitative middlemen by offering direct buy-back contracts and dependable prices for smallholder seaweed growers, improving income stability and market access.

Through technical services, seed supply, training, and quality control across the farming and supply chain, SEADLING ensures high-quality raw materials for downstream use.

Our proprietary fermentation and biotech processes create higher-value, functional ingredients (such as enhanced prebiotics and vitamin K2), expanding application into pet food, plant and animal health, and future human nutrition markets.

What were SEADLING's highlights in 2025?

We closed a successful \$1 million seed funding round, enabling expansion and scaling.

We launched a second processing facility in Sabah, Malaysia, significantly increasing production capacity for functional seaweed ingredients.

We also expanded exports of fermented seaweed products to markets including the US, Singapore, and India, and established partnerships with major agribusiness players.

Finally, we strengthened government and public support, with high-profile local launch events and recognition of SEADLING’s role in building Sabah’s biotech potential.

Plans for 2026?

We are aiming for key certifications (e.g., GMP+) to strengthen animal feed and ingredient quality assurance.

We will expand product lines and markets, including deeper penetration in pet food, plant biostimulants, and start the work for human products.

Expansion into India, Thailand, Europe, and China, and increasing production capacity, are also in the works for 2026

[Disclosure: AgFunder is an investor in Seadling.]



We bypass exploitative middlemen by offering direct buy-back contracts and dependable prices for smallholder seaweed growers, improving income stability and market access.

SEADLING FOUNDER SIMON DAVIS

seadling.com »



TAGADDOD TEAM

Total funding

\$260 million

in 2025

(+30% YOY)

Total upstream funding

\$96 million

in 2025

(-21% YOY)



Top category

Home & Cooking

\$85 MILLION FUNDING

(+215% YOY)

Top upstream category

Ag Marketplaces & Fintech

\$51 MILLION FUNDING

(-32% YOY)

Biggest deal

BURN \$80m

Debt (Kenya)

HOME & COOKING

Biggest upstream deal

Tagaddod \$26m

Series A (Egypt)

BIOENERGY & BIOMATERIALS



Africa spotlight:

10 years of funding



2025

Upstream

+161% YoY

\$149M VS. \$57M

Deals

-12% YoY

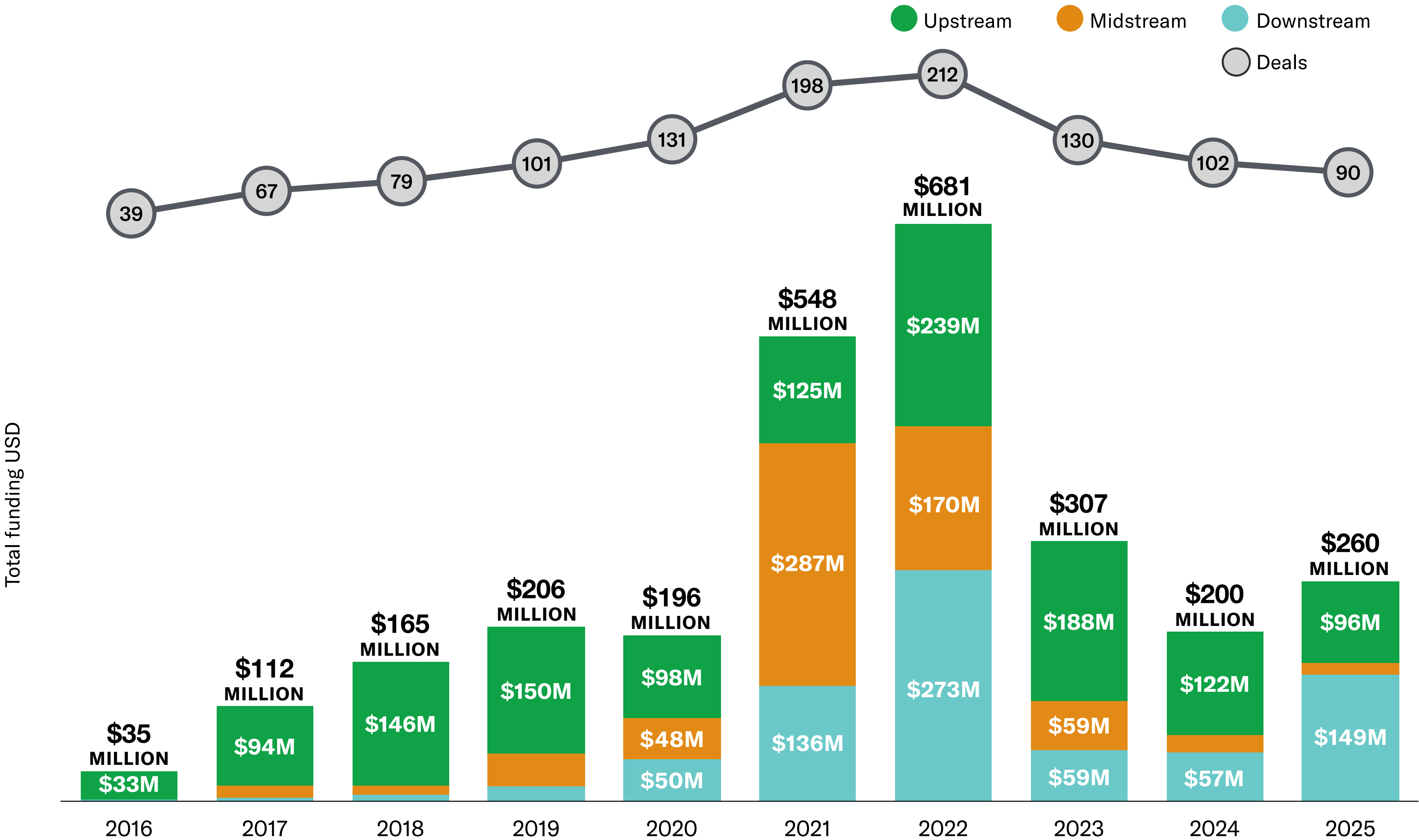
90 VS. 102

Median deal size

-61% YoY

\$500K VS. \$1.3M

Africa's total agrifoodtech investment 2016–2025



Africa spotlight:

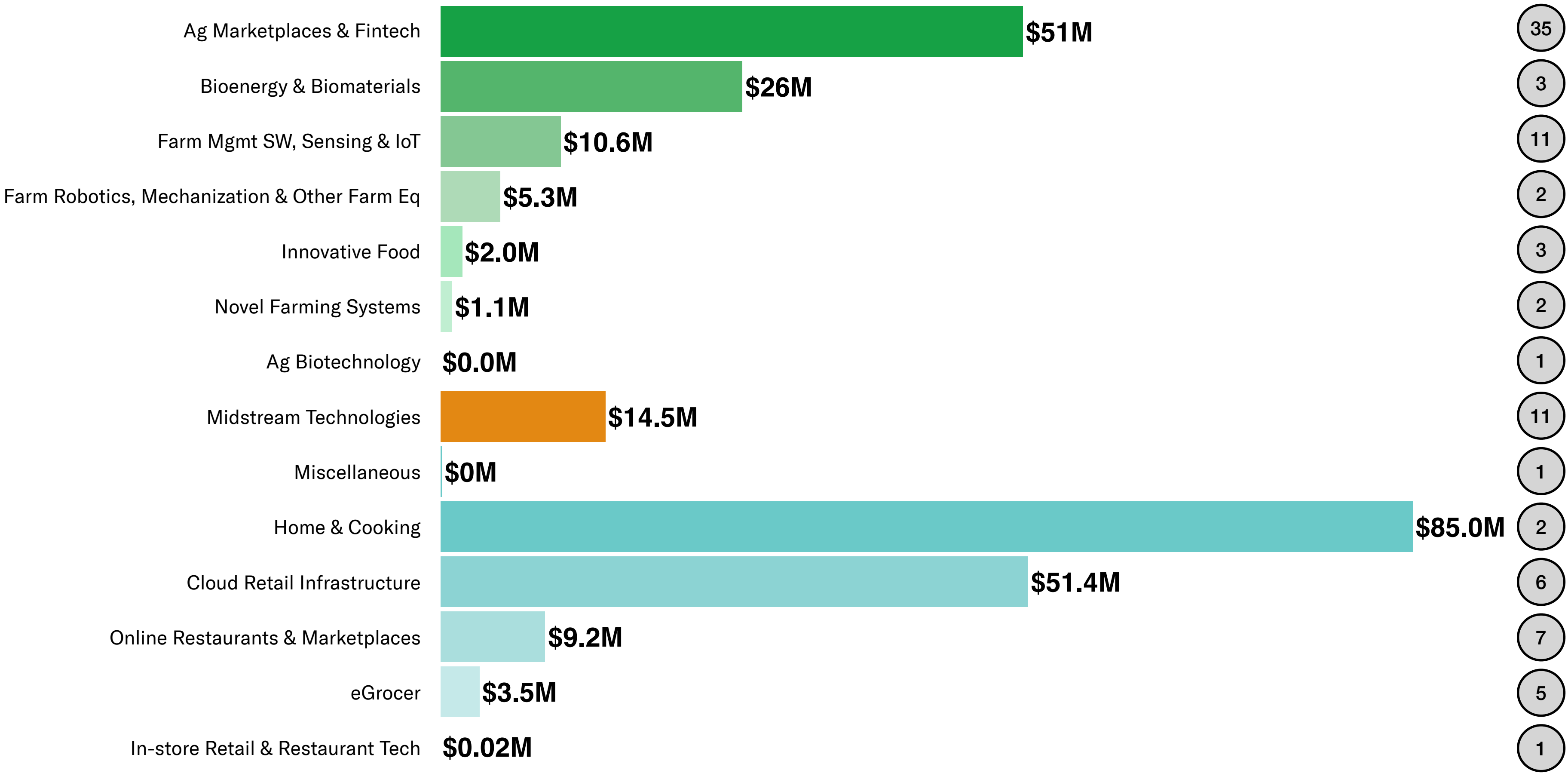
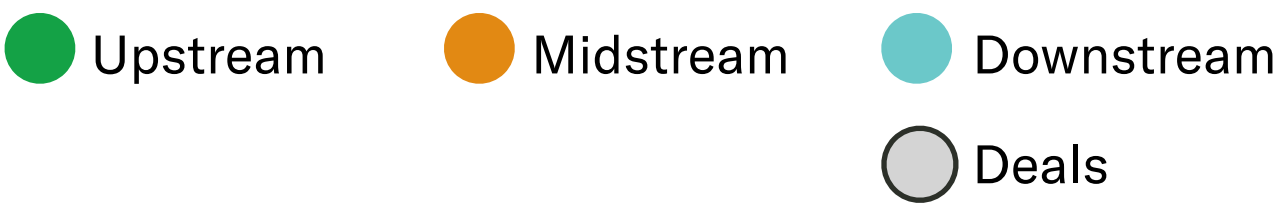
by category



Kenya-based BURN, which manufactures and distributes fuel-efficient cooking appliances such as biomass stoves, raised an \$80 million debt round in 2025, bumping the Home & Cooking category to the lead for downstream funding.

Upstream, Ag Marketplaces & Fintech continues to be a vital category connecting smallholder producers to quality inputs, financing options, and market access.

Africa’s funding by category 2025





Startup Profile - Complete Farmer



COMPLETE FARMER FOUNDER DESMOND KONEY

As an end-to-end agricultural marketplace, Complete Farmer believes that providing technology and ready markets to farmers, it is possible to modernize agriculture and make farming profitable. For this to happen, the company developed a model anchored on standardizing farming processes.

What were Complete Farmer's highlights in 2025?

We secured debt financing, enabling us to scale our fulfillment centers across Northern Ghana, and invest in post-harvest systems required to support farmers and buyers more reliably.

Our demo fields across regions achieved strong yields even under drought conditions, validating our protocols and reinforcing the importance of science-led, climate-smart farming practices.

Financially, we strengthened our foundation by onboarding SAVA, a South Africa-based digital banking infrastructure provider, to improve financial inclusiveness for farmers as we scale.

Complete Farmer ranked #2 among the “Top 10 SMEs Making Waves in African Tech,” and our impact amplified globally through features on CNN, BBC, AgFunderNews to name a few.

Plans for 2026?

This year we’re focused on closing our Series A funding round and commercializing our operations in the Togo Market to strengthen and extend our supply chain reach.

We’re also preparing to launch upgraded versions of our CF Grower and CF Buyer platforms—introducing powerful planning and intelligence tools, including crop planning, real-time seasonality insights, and AI-driven crop grading to improve quality consistency and strengthen buyer trust.

In parallel, we’re advancing our agronomic intelligence capabilities with APSIM-modelled crops, an expanding network of weather stations and soil probes, and multilingual IVR support to better serve farmers across regions.

We’re also strengthening relationships across our ecosystem through better access to landbanks, more reliable offtake via fulfillment centers, and SLA-driven customer success supported by CSAT and NPS tracking.

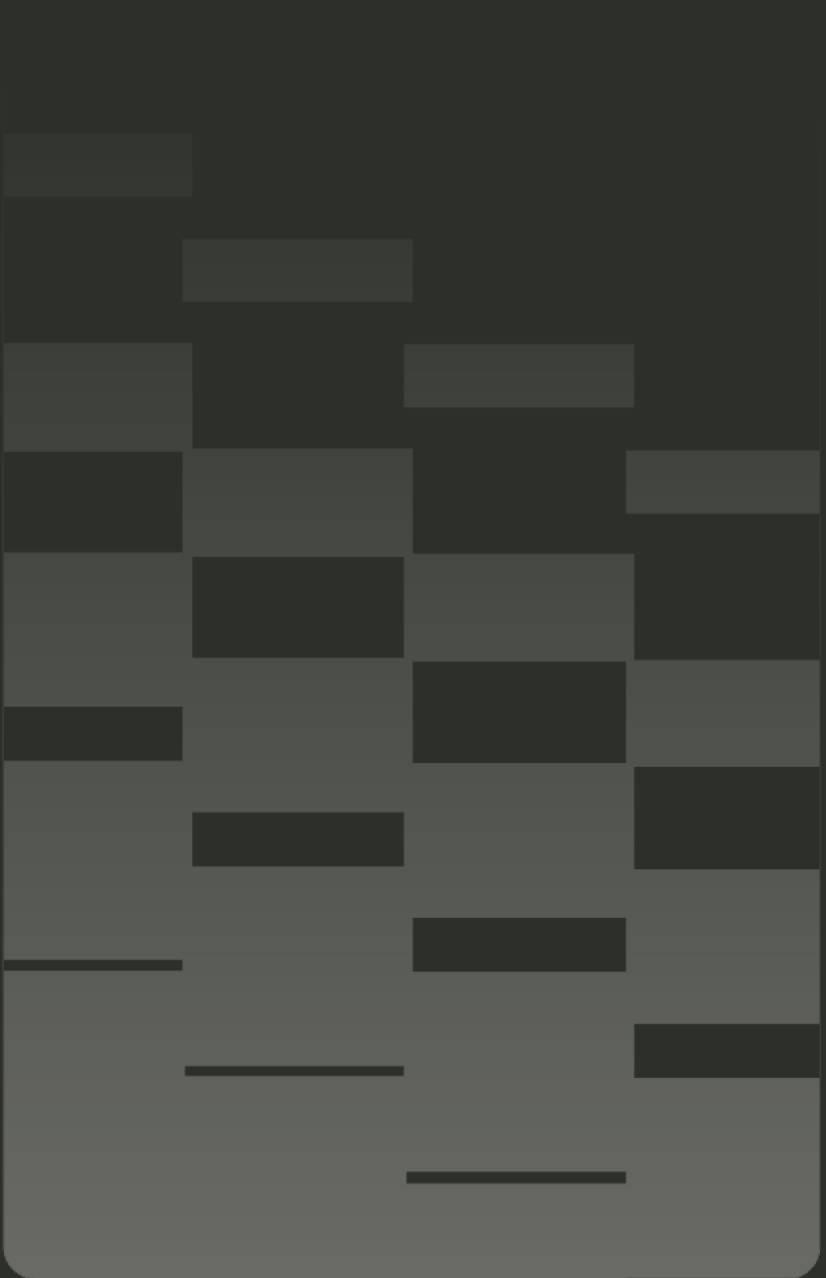
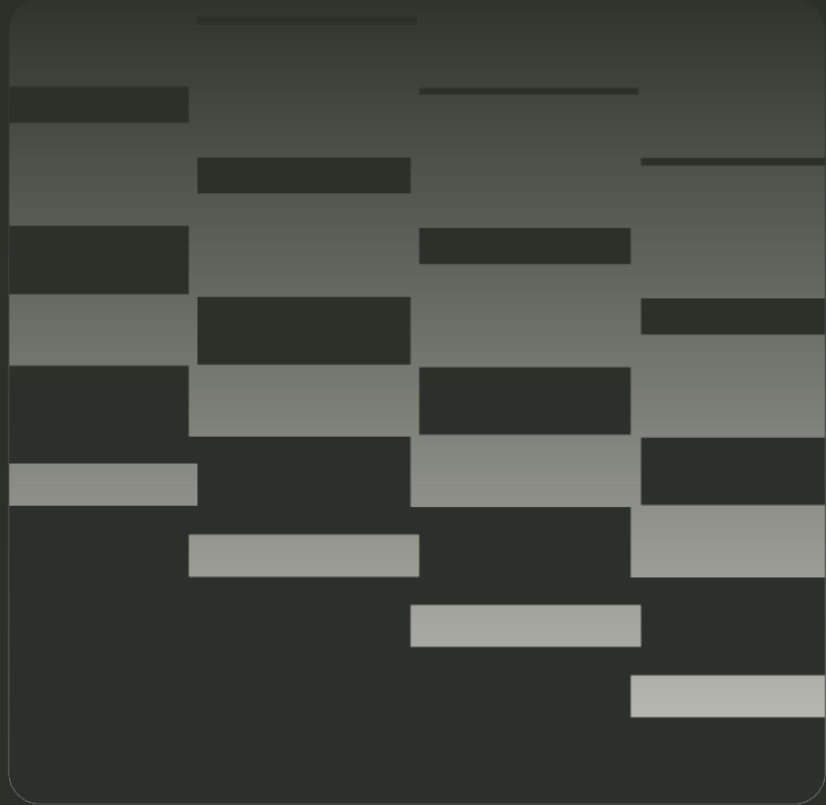
Furthermore, we’re scaling our cold chain infrastructure to enable entry into the fresh produce market, while also providing input financing to support thousands of growers on the CF Grower platform.



We continued to grow and deepen our farmer network in 2025, with growers consistently highlighting agronomic support as a key differentiator, while laying the groundwork to improve access to inputs, mechanization, and markets.

DESMOND KONEY

completefarmer.com»



YING SHAO PLANTIK BIOSCIENCES



2025 did not deliver category-defining exits. “It was all about groundwork: strengthening fundamentals, cleaning up balance sheets, and positioning startups for consolidation,” says Francisco Jardim at SP Ventures.

In 2026, says SOSV's Po Bronson, successful firms will "stop solving the world’s problems and solve customer problems."

VC predictions 2026



ROB LECLERC AGFUNDER

What do you predict for agrifoodtech in 2026?

"This is going to be the year of the [AI] agent. It may not hit agtech for 1-2 years but it's coming and we're going to see an entire internet for agents and this is going to deeply disintermediate traditional commercial channels."

ROB LECLERC, AGFUNDER

"I expect capital to further concentrate, with the middle—after seed, before growth—being squeezed the most. I also expect more secondaries as funds reach the end of their cycle and need liquidity."

MARK BROOKS, INDEPENDENT ADVISOR

“Physical AI agtech will draw a lot of capital and bring back 'tourist' VC. We're excited about founders capturing primary data at field and supply chain level — enabled by edge AI, robotics, IoT that now work autonomously."

ANTONY YOUSEFIAN, THE FIRST THIRTY

"Strategic capital from sovereign wealth funds and government-backed entities is becoming a more prominent feature of the landscape."

JASON SILM, CIBUS CAPITAL



MATILDA HO BITS X BITES

What are you excited about in 2026?

“AI is shifting from models to applications embedded in workflows, and agrifood is one of the largest 'real economy' opportunity sets where workflows are still under-digitized so ROI is unusually tangible."

MAARTEN GOOSSENS, ANTERRA CAPITAL

“The return of systemic liquidity, fueled by pro-growth national policies and support from state-backed 'patient capital' in China. We see this year not just as a recovery but as a transition to a more resilient, exit-focused investment cycle."

MATILDA HO, BITS X BITES

01

02



GENTIANE GORLIER THE YIELD LAB

What surprised you in 2025?

“How quickly agrifoodtech shifted from narrative-driven innovation to fundamentals-driven execution.”

FRANCISCO JARDEM, SP VENTURES

“Corporates became more open to partnerships—but still slow to commit when it came to cheques.”

GENTIANE GORLIER, THE YIELD LAB

“Climate change went from being a distant worry to a real pain for supply chains, causing some serious price spikes, especially in categories like coffee and matcha. 2025 really showed us that volatility is the new normal.”

MATILDA HO, BITS X BITES

"The speed at which fintech and agtech merged. The 'agfintech' space showed that financial inclusion is the true enabler for technology adoption in emerging markets. This is a natural next step for AI-driven risk models."

TOMAS PEÑA. THE YIELD LAB LATAM



MAARTEN GOOSSENS ANTERRA CAPITAL



JAAP STRENGERS FUTURE FOOD FUND

What annoyed you in 2025?

“Companies still receiving valuations as if they can exit at unicorns levels.”

JAAP STRENGERS, FUTURE FOOD FUND

“AI sucking up all growth capital globally.”

MARK KAHN, OMNIVORE

“Aggressive lead investors... leave something on the table for early backers or they won't come back and create deal flow for you in future.”

MARK DURN0, ROCKSTART

"AI decks with no data access plan, 'platform' claims without a wedge, climate buzzwords with unclear buyers, pilots presented as revenue, founders who dodge questions on gross margin, payback, and churn."

GENTIANE GORLIER, THE YIELD LAB



MARK KAHN OMNIVORE

Top 20 investors by number of deals 2025

Investor	HQ	DEALS PARTICIPATED IN*
SOSV	United States of America	27
The Yield Lab Latam	Argentina	18
Antler	Singapore	17
Big Idea Ventures	United States of America	15
AgFunder	United States of America	14
Eatable Adventures	Spain	14
Rockstart	Denmark	14
Y Combinator	United States of America	13
Plug and Play	United States of America	12
Anterra	The Netherlands	11
500 Startups	United States of America	10
Accel Partners	United States of America	10
ProVeg Incubator	Germany	10
S2G Ventures	United States of America	10
Alexandria Venture Investments	United States of America	9
ACCEL	Norway	9
Bpifrance	France	8
European Investment Bank (EIB)	Luxembourg	8
FJ Labs	United States of America	8
Global Brain Corporation	Japan	8

Unique investors

2929

IN 2025

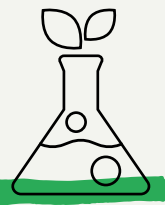
Unique HQ countries

80

IN 2025

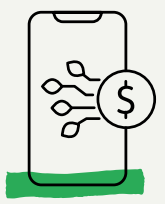
*number of deals into unique companies including follow-ons

Upstream



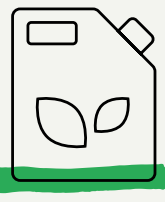
Ag Biotechnology

On-farm inputs for crop & animal ag including genetics, microbiome, breeding, animal health



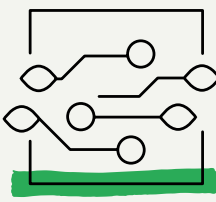
Agribusiness Marketplaces & Fintech

Commodities trading platforms, online input procurement, equipment leasing, farmer fintech



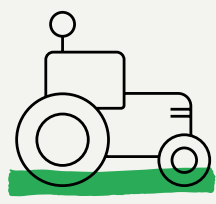
Bioenergy & Biomaterials

Non-food extraction & processing, feedstock technology, cannabis pharmaceuticals



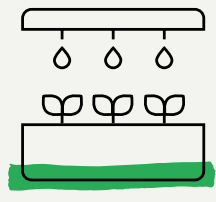
Farm Management Software, Sensing & IoT

Ag data capturing devices, decision support software, big data analytics



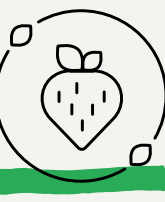
Farm Robotics, Mechanization & Equipment

On-farm machinery, automation, drone manufacturers, grow equipment



Novel Farming Systems

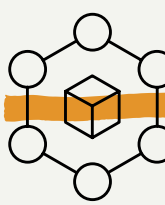
Indoor farms, aquaculture, insect and algae production



Innovative Food

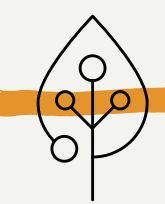
Cultured meat, novel ingredients, plant-based proteins

Midstream



Midstream Technologies

Food safety & traceability tech, logistics & transport, processing tech



Miscellaneous

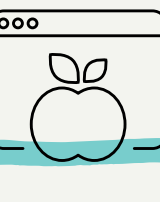
All other agrifood-related tech

Downstream



In-Store Retail & Restaurant Tech

Shelf-stacking robots, 3D food printers, payment systems, food waste monitoring IoT



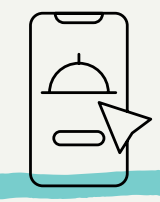
eGrocery

Online stores + marketplaces for sale and delivery of processed and unprocessed ag products to consumer



Home & Cooking Tech

Smart kitchen appliances, nutrition technologies, food testing devices & home grow kits



Online Restaurants and Meal Marketplaces

Online tech platforms delivering prepared food and meal kits from a wide range of vendors



Cloud Retail Infrastructure

On-demand enabling tech, ghost kitchens, last-mile delivery robots & services

Data sources & curation

Utilizing advanced machine-learning algorithms and artificial intelligence to help identify and categorize agrifoodtech startups, our knowledge base has grown to more than 30,000 companies, with new startups and historical data being added each day.

The raw data for our reports comes from Crunchbase, which gathers publicly available information such as press releases and US Securities and Exchange Commission filings.

AgFunder contributes data from its own collection methods, including private communications with investors and companies. We also collect data from partners across the globe. This year, our data partners included Africa the Big Deal, BitxBites (China), Omnivore VC (India), ShakeUp Factory (Europe).

We update and improve our dataset continuously throughout the year, meaning total figures from previous years’ reports will shift as our dataset becomes more complete. Please note that sometimes, revision and cleanup of rounds listed by external contributors can cause figures to decrease rather than increase.

Sources & methodology

Categorization

AgFunder’s categorization system is designed to capture broad themes across the complex agrifoodtech value chain. The agrifood sector has a wide supply chain spanning inputs and industrials, farming, logistics, wholesale distribution, processing, retail distribution, and the consumer. In many cases, technologies such as marketplaces connect different links in the supply chain, and so in this report we’ve chosen to focus on high-level themes.

To assist with the categorization and to avoid subjectivity, AgFunder first employs over 150 machine learning and artificial intelligence models to suggest category placement and to help tag the company according to the technology and its place in the supply chain. Finally, AgFunder and its partners manually review the suggestions for each company.

Defining deeptech

We classify deeptech as companies whose core competitive advantage is rooted in scientific or engineering innovation.

A deeptech company is characterised by one or more of the following properties:

-Novel science or engineering at the core of its product or process (e.g., synthetic biology, advanced materials, quantum computing).

-Significant R&D intensity, including proprietary patents, lab-scale or pilot-plant operations, and interdisciplinary scientific teams.

-Hardware or hard-science orientation, where the primary value is created through physical or biological systems rather than purely through software interfaces or digital marketplaces.

-Long development cycles and high capital requirements reflecting the complexity and depth of the underlying technology.

Defining climate tech

We classify climate tech as companies whose core products or services are directly aimed at addressing climate change. This includes one or more of the following properties:

-The core offering must have a direct climate impact to meaningfully reduce, avoid or remove emissions, or materially enhance climate adaptation capacity.

-Carbon management; capture, sequestration, removal, offsetting of CO2 and other GHG gases

-Sustainable materials and the circular economy are primarily aimed at removing fossil-derived materials or processes.

-Climate-smart agriculture and land use (e.g. regenerative practices, methane

reduction, precision agriculture, alternative food production methods) for climate adaptation.

Dual-scoring classification approach

We currently use a dual-scoring approach, which takes both sides into account with a few advantages:

-Nuance over binary thresholds. A dual-score system captures the relative strength of evidence in both directions, rather than relying on an arbitrary cut-off point.

-Robustness to noisy descriptions. Company descriptions often contain marketing language alongside technical detail. By scoring both for and against deeptech simultaneously, the model is resistant to cases where a genuinely innovative company uses commercial language, and vice versa.

-Conservative by default. The base prior towards "not deeptech" or “not climate” ensures that ambiguous cases are not falsely inflated, preserving the integrity of the designation.

-Transparency and auditability. Every classification can be traced back to explicit keyword matches and category signals.

Undisclosed financings

Of the 2,031 financing rounds featured in this report, 575 had undisclosed dollar totals. We exclude undisclosed financings when computing median values. In some cases, we confidentially obtain financing figures on the condition that they’re included only in aggregate.

Multiple company financings

In some cases, Crunchbase displays multiple financings for the same company in the same year. This can be because a company closes subsequent rounds in the same year, but it can also be the result of several closes of the same round. We keep them separate unless they are announced as one single round.

Defining developed and developing markets

In 2025, we introduced new sections for developed and developing markets. This was based on feedback from readers and partners who wanted to see comparable markets with similar drivers combined and compared. This is a break from our earlier approach of separate reports on geographical regions, some of which

combined developing and developed economies, as in Asia-Pacific. In our definition, the term "developing markets" is interchangeable with Global South, and is sometimes called "emerging markets," too. Our definition of developing markets comes primarily from the list of G77 countries of the United Nations, a list that’s now 134 strong that is found [here](#). We made a few adjustments, notably adding Mexico and removing China and South Korea, as investors increasingly treat the latter two as developed markets given their size and maturity.

Sharing rights

While we are happy to share our findings, we reserve all rights with respect to AgFunder research, and we require it to be fully and accurately cited when any of the data, charts, or commentary are used. If you’d like to access our data for your own research, please contact louisa@agfunder.com to learn more about our partnership opportunities. Email partnerships@agfunder.com for sponsorship options.

Special acknowledgment

We’d like to give special thanks to Tim Li and the rest of the Crunchbase team for their continued support and assistance. **Thank you to all our data partners,** listed below, for their contribution to making ours the most comprehensive database of agrifoodtech companies and investments globally, especially Kevin Camphius from ShakeUp Factory for his neverending support.

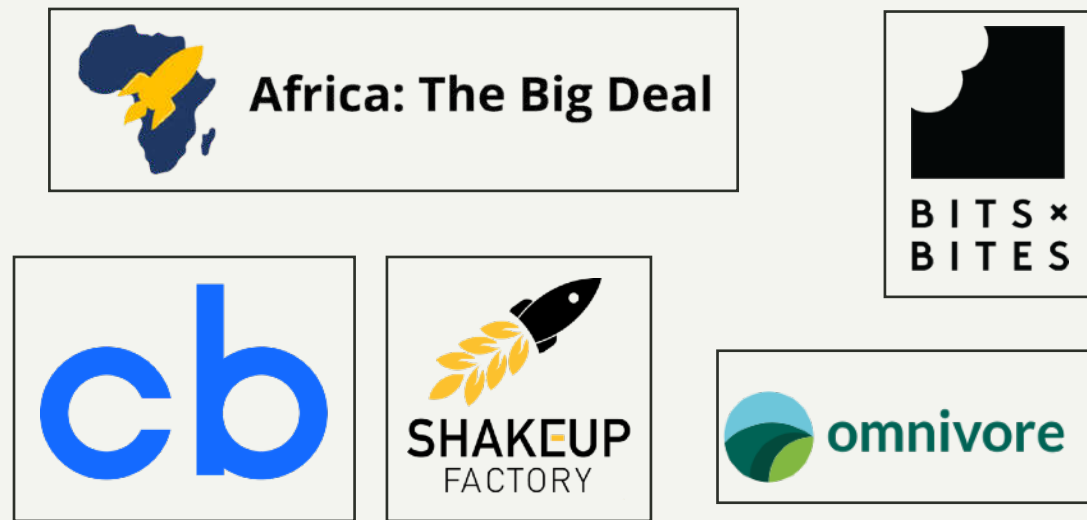


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